

Teacher Guide — French Revolution

History | Grade 9-10

Period 1

Entry Ticket

Write two short answers (2 minutes each):

1) One sentence: What image or symbol comes to mind when you hear the word “revolution”?

2) One sentence: For the French Revolution, did the Bastille hold many political prisoners when it was stormed, or only a few? Circle one: MANY / A FEW

Be ready to explain your choice in one sentence.

Expected response: 1) A vivid symbol (e.g., crowds, flags, broken chains, storming a prison). 2) A FEW — correct answer: the Bastille held only a few prisoners at the time (often a common misconception is to answer MANY).

Teacher Script

0-5 min: Warm-up: whole-class brainstorm and record

Collect entry tickets quickly: ask for two volunteers to read their answers to the symbol question and one volunteer to read their Bastille answer. Say: “Put your pens down. Tell us the single image you wrote for ‘revolution’ — one phrase only.” After 2–3 answers, ask: “Who answered MANY for the Bastille? Who answered A FEW?” Note the split. Tell the class: “We’ll compare these ideas with short contemporary evidence in a few minutes.”

Board: Write two column headings: left = ‘Revolution symbols’ ; right = ‘Bastille: MANY or A FEW?’. Under each, record the short phrases students call out and tally answers for MANY and A FEW.

- Anticipate: What counts as a ‘symbol’—does a date or event count? (Answer: yes if a student names a date like 14 July.)
- Anticipate: Do we have to explain why we chose MANY/A FEW? (Answer: not now — save the explanation for later when we look at evidence.)
- Anticipate: If I wasn’t sure what the Bastille was, can I still answer? (Answer: Yes; write your best idea — this is to surface beliefs.)

5-12 min: Mini-lecture: core facts with primary evidence and competing views

Say: “We will now establish the basic facts historians use. Listen for two dates and one event.” Read aloud slowly: “Historians date the French Revolution from 5 May 1789 to 9 November 1799 (the Coup of 18 Brumaire). That span is ten years, six months, and four days.” Pause, point to board dates. Continue: “A key emblematic event is the Storming of the Bastille on 14 July 1789. Contemporary eyewitness accounts describe crowds, the governor negotiating, and the fall and demolition of the building in the days after.” Read a short primary excerpt (teacher holds up or reads): “A Parisian witness: ‘We entered the Bastille and found only a handful of prisoners; the building’s fall filled the crowd with joy.’ ” Then say: “Historians disagree about the Bastille’s meaning. Some treat it as a symbolic attack on the Ancien Régime; others argue it was a practical action driven by weapons and local tensions. Both views are supported by sources.” Ask: “Any questions about the dates or the Bastille as an event?” Wait briefly for 1–2 quick questions.

Board: Add these lines: • Dates: 5 May 1789 9 Nov 1799 (10 yrs, 6 mo, 4 days) • Key event: Bastille stormed 14 July 1789. Underline ‘Bastille’ and write: ‘symbol of Ancien Régime’ and ‘demolished after fall.’ Also write a short quoted line: ‘only a handful of prisoners’ (source).

- Anticipate: Why start on 5 May 1789 rather than an earlier date? (Answer: because the Estates General convened then and it begins the political sequence taught in this course.)
- Anticipate: Is 9 November 1799 really the end? (Answer: It marks the Coup of 18 Brumaire —

historians use it as the end point because it ends the revolutionary governments.)

- Anticipate: Did the eyewitness quote mean the Bastille wasn't important? (Answer: No — it was symbolically important even if it held few prisoners.)

12-24 min: Small-group source analysis: causes and evidence

Tell students: "Form groups of four. Each group gets a printed excerpt (or listen as I read) describing causes: social, economic, financial, political, plus one excerpt about the Bastille. Your job: list specific short-term and long-term causes named, and mark each item as (E) if the text gives direct evidence or (I) if it's the author's interpretation. I will read one short excerpt aloud now as an example: 'Bread prices rose sharply in 1788–1789; complaints in marketplaces increased; pamphlets blamed the monarchy's financial mismanagement.' Pause after each sentence to let groups write. Start your group work now. I will circulate and listen for one minute to each group and ask: 'Which line in your excerpt shows a short-term cause?' " After one minute of circulating, prompt: "You have ten minutes total. If you finish early, prepare one piece of direct evidence to share in the next activity."

Board: On the right side, draw two labeled lists: 'Short-term causes (from texts)' and 'Long-term causes (from texts)'. Leave space under each for groups to add one example when we share.

- Anticipate: What's the difference between direct evidence and interpretation? (Answer: Direct evidence is a specific fact or quote in the text; interpretation is the author explaining why that fact mattered.)
- Anticipate: Can a cause be both short-term and long-term? (Answer: A factor can have both immediate effects and long roots — mark the way the text presents it.)
- Anticipate: If my group can't read the excerpt well, can you read it aloud? (Answer: Yes — ask me and I will read it.)

24-34 min: Structured debate / role-play: whose causes mattered most?

Assign each group a perspective: peasants, urban workers, nobility, political intellectuals. Say: "Each group has three minutes to prepare a 60–90 second argument: name the top two causes from your documents and cite one direct piece of evidence for each. You must also say one thing you accept from another group's view. After three minutes, each group will present for 90 seconds. I will time you." Circulate while groups prepare, prompt with questions: "What evidence will you quote? Where is it on your page?" Then run the presentations: call each group in turn, keep presentations to time, and allow one clarifying question from the class after each presentation.

Board: Under the earlier short-/long-term lists, add four labels for perspectives and jot one key cause each presenting group names as they speak (one-line notes).

- Anticipate: What if our evidence is only interpretation? (Answer: Be honest — say it's interpretation and explain why the text gives that interpretation.)
- Anticipate: Can we use points from other groups in our argument? (Answer: Yes — you should acknowledge them and explain why you still prioritize your causes.)
- Anticipate: How long should the quote be when we cite evidence? (Answer: Keep it short: a short phrase or specific fact is best.)

34-38 min: Debrief and exit ticket (check for understanding)

Ask two targeted whole-class questions: 1) "Name one specific piece of evidence you heard today that supports a short-term cause." Call on volunteers. 2) "Name one piece of evidence for a long-term cause." After answers, explain briefly: "Good — record one short-term evidence and one long-term evidence on your exit ticket. Your ticket also answers: Why is the Bastille important as a

symbol even if it held only a few prisoners?" Give the written exit ticket and collect after 3 minutes.

Board: Write the two check questions on the board for students to copy: 1) Short-term evidence — ____ 2)

Long-term evidence — ____ and the Bastille question: 'Symbol vs. reality: why important?'

- Anticipate: Do we need to write full sentences on the exit ticket? (Answer: One clear sentence for each is enough.)
- Anticipate: If we can't remember the exact quote, can we paraphrase? (Answer: Yes — paraphrase clearly and note where it came from.)
- Anticipate: Will these tickets be graded? (Answer: They are quick checks for understanding and will be read for feedback.)

38-40 min: Consolidate and link forward

Summarize aloud: "Today we fixed three core facts: the Revolution's dates (5 May 1789–9 Nov 1799), the Storming of the Bastille (14 July 1789), and that causes were multiple — social, economic, financial, political — with evidence supporting some claims and interpretation for others. Note the contested meaning of the Bastille: symbol for many, but only a few prisoners were inside. Next period we will use this evidence base to study the Reign of Terror and the Estates General. Any final quick question? (Pause briefly.) Thank students and remind them to hand in exit tickets."

Board: Add one final summary line at top: 'CONSOLIDATION: dates, Bastille (event + symbol), multi-causal evidence approach.'

- Anticipate: Will we study the Estates General next? (Answer: Yes — we will examine it and the National Assembly in upcoming periods.)
- Anticipate: Do we need to memorize the exact dates? (Answer: Learn the two dates given; they help structure the whole unit.)
- Anticipate: Will we revisit the Bastille sources again? (Answer: Yes — we will compare more sources later when studying political symbolism.)

Blackboard Notes

- CONSOLIDATION: dates, Bastille (event + symbol), multi-causal evidence approach
- Revolution symbols
- Bastille: MANY or A FEW?
- Key facts & evidence
- Short-term causes (from texts)
- Long-term causes (from texts)
- Perspectives (notes from presentations)
- Exit ticket questions
- Dates: 5 May 1789 9 Nov 1799 (10 yrs, 6 mo, 4 days)
- Storming of the Bastille: 14 July 1789 — building demolished in following weeks
- "only a handful of prisoners" (eyewitness quote)
- Bastille: symbol of Ancien Régime; historians disagree on symbolic vs. practical importance
- Short-term causes (examples students may list): bread price rises, immediate financial crisis, riots, shortages (mark as E or I)
- Long-term causes (examples students may list): social inequality of Estates system, long-term royal debt, Enlightenment political ideas (mark as E or I)
- Example sequence to trace (class example): Estates-General Third Estate forms National Assembly urban unrest Bastille August Decrees
- Exit ticket: 1) one short-term evidence — ____ 2) one long-term evidence — ____ 3) Why is the

Bastille an important symbol even if it held few prisoners?

- Diagram: Simple timeline: 5 May 1789 — [Estates-General] — 14 July 1789 (Bastille) — August 1789 (August Decrees) — 9 Nov 1799 (18 Brumaire/Coup)
- Diagram: Two-column chart: Left column 'Short-term causes' ; Right column 'Long-term causes' with arrows showing how long-term causes can lead to short-term triggers

Activities

Mini-debate: What sparked the French Revolution in 1789? (12 min, debate)

Materials: One printed short evidence sheet per pair (teacher can cut a single A4 into slips; see suggested extract lines below), Timer or stopwatch, Paper and pen for each student, One sheet of chart paper or whiteboard space for each team to record main claims

1. Arrange students in pairs and then combine two pairs into small debate teams (teams of four: two students pro, two students con). Give each pair one evidence slip and a blank team chart paper space. Announce: "You have 12 minutes total: 4 minutes prepare, 6 minutes debate, 2 minutes wrap-up." Start the timer.
2. During the 4-minute preparation: circulate and prompt teams to list short-term causes and long-term causes from their slips, and to decide which two claims their team will defend. Remind them to cite the evidence slip line numbers aloud during debate.
3. Run the 6-minute debate as two timed rounds: Round A (3 minutes) — Team 1 presents their two claims with evidence (each speaker 45 seconds). Round B (3 minutes) — Team 2 responds and presents counter-claims with evidence (each speaker 45 seconds). Use the timer and call time at 30 seconds and 10 seconds left for each speaker.
4. For the 2-minute wrap-up: ask each team to post their chart paper summary (two claims + evidence lines, one short-term and one long-term cause). While students post, note any charts that mention the Bastille and whether they specify the misconception about political prisoners.
5. After activity ends, give one-minute feedback to the whole class: point out competing interpretations you observed and correct the Bastille misconception by stating the historical evidence (that the Bastille held few if any political prisoners on 14 July 1789).

Student instructions:

- Preparation (4 minutes): Read your pair's evidence slip carefully. On your team chart paper, write two claims your team will argue: one short-term cause and one long-term cause of the 1789 Revolution. For each claim, copy the exact phrase or line number from your slip that supports it.
- Debate (6 minutes): When your team speaks, each speaker has about 45 seconds. Present your two claims in clear order: say 'Short-term cause: [claim], evidence: [quote or slip line].' Then 'Long-term cause: [claim], evidence: [quote or slip line].' When responding, point out where you disagree and offer alternative evidence from your slip. Do not shout; keep to time.
- Wrap-up (2 minutes): Together, post your chart paper with the two claims and their evidence lines. Be ready to point to the evidence if the teacher asks one question.

Success looks like: Each team posts a chart paper that shows two labelled claims (one short-term, one long-term) each with a copied quote or slip line number.; During the debate, at least one speaker from each team cites the slip by quoting a phrase or stating a line number aloud.; At least one team mentions the Bastille and either states or corrects the misconception by citing evidence about prisoner numbers or the Bastille's symbolic role.

Support: Pair a student who struggles to start with a stronger partner. Give this sentence frame and a worked example to the struggling student: 'Short-term cause: [food shortages]. Evidence: "line 3: rising bread prices"'. Worked first item for them to copy: Short-term cause: rising bread prices. Evidence: line 3: 'bread prices rose

sharply in 1788–89'. Use only one claim if time is short.

Extension: Choose one claim your team lost the debate on. Prepare a one-minute rebuttal that connects that claim to the wider ten-year timeline (1789–1799): how might this cause have contributed to later events such as political radicalization or Napoleon's rise? Cite at least one specific event or date from the Revolution that could follow from your causal link.

Checkpoint Questions

- [analyze] Name one short-term cause and one long-term cause of the Revolution found in the class sources. For each, give the exact piece of evidence (a short quote or a paraphrase of a line) that supports it.

Expected: Short-term: 'high bread prices' or 'food shortages' (evidence: a contemporary report or quote describing riots or bread lines). Long-term: 'privileges of the First and Second Estates' or 'inequality between estates' (evidence: a document listing exemptions from taxes or the Third Estate's grievances).

- [analyze] The Bastille was torn down and became a powerful symbol. Using the sources, explain in one sentence why it was symbolic even though it held very few prisoners.

Expected: Because sources show contemporaries reacted to the Bastille as a symbol of royal authority and arbitrary detention, even though records note it held only about seven prisoners at the time; the demolition and contemporary accounts show symbolic meaning outweighed its actual prisoner numbers.

- [analyze] A short extract says 'the crown's debts were unsustainable.' Which cause category is this, and is that extract direct evidence of the Revolution starting or an interpretation? Briefly justify your choice.

Expected: Category: financial cause. Whether it is direct evidence or interpretation depends on the extract: if it gives figures or records of deficit it's direct evidence; if it asserts that the debt caused the Revolution without data, it's an interpretation. The student should point to whether the quote includes numbers/records (evidence) or a causal claim (interpretation).

Exit Ticket

In one short paragraph, list two long-term causes and two short-term causes named in the lesson's documents. For each cause give one specific piece of evidence from the sources (a short quote or a precise paraphrase).

Success indicator: The response lists two long-term and two short-term causes, and attaches a specific supporting piece of evidence to each (quote or precise paraphrase); causes are correctly sorted into long-term vs short-term.

Homework

- Write a one-page (350 words) response that organizes causes into the four categories used in class (social, economic, financial, political). For each category: name two causes found in the sources and add the line of evidence from class documents that supports each cause.
- Correct the common misconception about the Bastille in two clear sentences: state the misconception, what the sources actually say about prisoner numbers, and why contemporaries still treated the Bastille as a powerful symbol.
- Find one short primary-source quote (one or two sentences) about food prices, taxation, or estate privileges from a textbook or library source and bring it to the next lesson with a one-sentence note on which cause category it supports.

Estimated time: 45 min

Mentor Moment — When a small fact changes a big story

A teacher once showed students that the Bastille held only seven prisoners; at first they were surprised, then they used that fact to ask why people tore it down. That question led to a richer class debate about symbols vs. facts.

Takeaway: A small factual detail can help you ask better historical questions—use facts to test big claims, not to stop looking for causes.

Period 2

Entry Ticket

Write one short sentence answering BOTH parts: (1) Which of these do you think was most important in causing the French Revolution: bad harvests, high taxes, or Enlightenment ideas? (2) Give one short reason (one clause) for your choice. Be ready to read your sentence aloud.

Expected response: Example: "Bad harvests — because food shortages made city prices explode and people blamed the government."

Teacher Script

0-5 min: Recap and share one prior fact

Say: "We are continuing from Origins and Opening Acts. In one sentence please read your entry ticket aloud when I point to you. After three people, I will ask for one factual correction or addition." Point to student A, B, C to read. After three, say: "Quick class check: who can state one clear fact about the Storming of the Bastille or the role of the Estates General?" Accept one-sentence answers. If a student says 'the Estates General voted as one body', correct: "Remember: it met in three estates and how they voted was the dispute — we will return to that."

Board: Write: "Quick recap: Storming of the Bastille; Estates General called (May 1789)."

- Anticipate: Was the Bastille the start of the Revolution?
- Anticipate: Did the Estates General meet for the first time in 1789?
- Anticipate: What were the three estates exactly?

5-13 min: Teacher presentation: Estates General National Assembly and dates

Say: "Listen as I tell a short sequence of dated steps. I will point at the dates on the board. Follow along and underline any word you don't know." Read clearly: "May 1789: King summons the Estates General, a body that last met in 1614 and which had three estates — clergy, nobility, Third Estate. Voting procedures were contested: the Third Estate wanted to vote by head, not by estate. In June 1789 the Third Estate declared itself the National Assembly, saying it represented the nation and would act as a constituent authority. Urban unrest followed, including the Storming of the Bastille in July, and the Assembly then moved to radical changes including the August Decrees." Then say: "Now a short factual overview of the Reign of Terror: from September 1793 to July 1794 revolutionary authorities arrested about 300,000 people and executed roughly 16,600 for counter-revolutionary activity. These are the numbers historians use as evidence; there are also different interpretations about why the Terror happened." Pause and ask: "Which date marks the start of the Terror? Which body declared itself in June 1789?"

Board: Write dated sequence as bullets and the Reign of Terror definition and numbers.

- Anticipate: Why did the Third Estate declare itself the National Assembly?
- Anticipate: Did the National Assembly cause the Bastille to be stormed?
- Anticipate: Are the arrest and execution numbers exact?

13-25 min: Small-group source analysis: causes (long-term vs short-term)

Say: "Form groups of four. Each group gets one short extract to read: population growth; bad harvests and economic recession; tax system and resistance to reform; Enlightenment ideas. Read the extract aloud once (2 minutes). Then mark whether the extract describes a long-term cause or a short-term trigger and copy one line of evidence from the extract that supports your choice (6 minutes). I will circulate and listen to one group's reasoning. Be ready to report: your cause,

long-term or short-term, and one quoted line as evidence (4 minutes)." Walk to groups, listen, and prompt with: "Which phrase shows time length? Where in the text does it say immediate impact?"

Board: Write group labels: A: population growth, B: bad harvests, C: tax system, D: Enlightenment. Under each, leave space for students to add one quoted evidence line.

- Anticipate: How do we decide long-term vs short-term?
- Anticipate: Can one cause be both long-term and short-term?
- Anticipate: What counts as a good quote for evidence?

25-35 min: Structured role-play debate: moderates vs radicals

Say: "Now split the class into two halves: moderates and radicals. Moderates argue that the National Assembly's steps were careful and did not justify extraordinary emergency measures. Radicals argue that the political crisis and threats made emergency measures likely. Use your group's evidence from the extracts: each side gets two minutes to state their main point and one piece of quoted evidence. Then each side gets one minute to rebut. Follow this script: statement (2 min), evidence read (2 min), rebuttal (1 min). I will time and call for the rebuttal. Begin." Circulate, remind students to name the cause they cite and to quote the line they used in the small-group activity. If students fall into the misconception that the Terror had united support, ask: "Where in our evidence do we see disagreements among revolutionaries?"

Board: Write debate roles and timing: "Moderates: statement 2', evidence 2', rebuttal 1' — Radicals: same."

- Anticipate: Can we use different evidence than our small-group extract?
- Anticipate: Who were the moderates and who were the radicals?
- Anticipate: Does debating mean we choose a side as our real belief?

35-38 min: Check for understanding: exit questions

Say: "On a slip of paper, write three short answers: (1) List two causes of the Revolution and one short piece of evidence for each (one phrase each). (2) Write one dated step showing how the Estates General became the National Assembly (one line)." Collect slips or have students drop them in the tray. If a student writes only 'the Terror was supported by all revolutionaries,' ask them to add a line noting a division (for example, factions or Robespierre vs Hébertists)."

Board: Write exit task instructions exactly as students must copy them.

- Anticipate: How long do the answers need to be?
- Anticipate: Do I have to write dates for both answers?
- Anticipate: What if I can't remember an exact phrase for evidence?

38-40 min: Consolidate and assign homework

Say: "We covered the sequence from the Estates General to the National Assembly and the Reign of Terror's scope. Two interpretations stand out: (1) the Terror resulted from coherent central policy, and (2) it resulted from internal divisions, emergency pressures and contested decisions. For homework, write one paragraph citing one cause from today and explain, with one quoted line of evidence from today's extracts, how that cause helped lead to later events. That will prepare you for the Declaration of the Rights of Man next lesson." Repeat the homework exactly and tell students where to hand it in.

Board: Write homework: "One-paragraph: pick one cause, cite one quote from today's extracts, explain link to later events. Due next class."

- Anticipate: How long should the paragraph be?
- Anticipate: Can we use class notes or must we quote the extract?
- Anticipate: What if we disagree with the interpretations?

Blackboard Notes

- Quick recap
- Sequence: Estates General National Assembly Bastille August Decrees
- Reign of Terror (definition & numbers)
- Group causes (A–D)
- Exit task
- Homework
- Quick recap: Storming of the Bastille; Estates General called (May 1789).
- May 1789 — Estates General summoned (last met 1614). Met in three estates: clergy, nobility, Third Estate.
- June 1789 — Third Estate declared itself the National Assembly (declared it represented the nation and acted as a constituent authority).
- July 1789 — Storming of the Bastille and urban unrest followed.
- August 1789 — Assembly pushed major reforms (August Decrees).
- Reign of Terror: Sept 1793–July 1794.
- Arrests 300,000; Executions 16,600 (on charges of counter-revolutionary activity).
- Causes (groups): A. Population growth — long-term social pressure.
- B. Bad harvests & recession — short-term economic triggers (food shortages, price rises).
- C. Tax system & resistance to reform — financial pressure and political conflict.
- D. Enlightenment ideas — political and cultural influence on expectations and rights.
- Exit task: On a slip — (1) Two causes + one short piece of evidence each. (2) One dated step: Estates General National Assembly.
- Homework: One paragraph. Choose one cause, quote one line from today's extracts, explain how it links to later events. Due next class.
- Diagram: Simple timeline: May 1789 June 1789 July 1789 Aug 1789 Sept 1793–July 1794 (label each event).
- Diagram: Three-box diagram showing 'Estates General' split into 'Clergy', 'Nobility', 'Third Estate' with arrow from Third Estate to 'National Assembly'.

Activities

Weighing Causes and Sequence: Small-Group Evidence Discussion (12 min, group_discussion)

Materials: One printed evidence slip per pair (teacher prepares 6 slips from the textbook or supplied document: two about long-term causes, two about short-term triggers, one about Estates General events, one about the Reign of Terror statistics), Stopwatch or visible timer, Whiteboard or chart paper and marker for each group (or a pair share one)

1. Organize students into pairs. Give each pair one evidence slip, a sheet of chart paper (or a blank area on the board), and a marker. Display a visible 12-minute timer and announce the task: analyze this piece of evidence, decide which cause(s) it supports (long-term social, economic, financial, political; or short-term trigger), and whether it helps explain how the Estates General led to the National Assembly or provides evidence about the Reign of Terror.
2. Say: 'In two minutes quietly read your slip and underline the exact words that support a cause or a sequence of events. Then you have five minutes to talk with your partner and write one sentence on the chart that cites the evidence and names the cause or event it supports. Finish by preparing one question to challenge a different interpretation.' Start the timer for 2 minutes of silent reading; give a 30-second warning.

- 3. Start the five-minute paired discussion. While pairs work, circulate and listen: when you hear a pair argue about whether a slip is long-term or short-term, ask them to point to the words that made them decide. If a pair cannot start after the silent reading, give them the support scaffold (see Support).
- 4. After five minutes of paired discussion, call a 3-minute round-robin: each pair reads their one-sentence claim plus their challenge question aloud (limit 30 seconds per pair). Track time and prompt pairs to stop at 30 seconds. Record any differing interpretations on the class board under two columns labeled 'Causes/Sequence' and 'Reign of Terror evidence'.
- 5. In the final 2 minutes, ask the whole class to vote (show of hands) on one contested interpretation recorded on the board (teacher selects one contested item). Conclude by reading aloud the Reign of Terror statistic from the slip and say: 'Notice the statistic is evidence; what it does not show by itself is whether all revolutionaries supported mass repression.'

Student instructions:

- 1. With your partner, quietly read the evidence slip for 2 minutes. Underline the exact words that show a cause (long-term or short-term), an action at the Estates General, or a fact about the Reign of Terror.
- 2. For 5 minutes discuss with your partner and then write one clear sentence on the chart paper that: names the cause or sequence your slip supports, quotes the underlined words, and states whether this is a long-term factor, a short-term trigger, an action in 1789, or a Reign of Terror statistic. Example sentence frame: 'This slip shows [short-term/long-term/sequence/Reign of Terror] because "[quote from slip]", which supports [named cause or event].'
- 3. Together create one short question that challenges another interpretation of your slip (for example: 'Could this economic complaint be short-term rather than long-term? Why or why not?'). Be ready to read your sentence and question aloud in the round-robin.
- 4. When pairs speak in the round-robin, listen and note one piece of evidence you might add to their claim. At the end, raise your hand to vote on the contested item the teacher chooses.

Success looks like: Each pair has a sentence on chart paper that quotes the slip and labels it as a long-term factor, short-term trigger, Estates General action, or Reign of Terror statistic.; Pairs can point to the exact words on their slip they used to justify their labelled cause or sequence during the teacher's circulation.; During the round-robin at least two different interpretations of a single slip are recorded on the board (teacher sees at least one disagreement noted).

Support: If you cannot start: use this sentence frame and the worked example. Frame: 'This slip shows [long-term/short-term/sequence/Reign of Terror] because "[short quote]", so it supports [named cause].' Worked example: if your slip says 'bad harvests and rising bread prices', write: 'This slip shows a long-term economic/social cause because "bad harvests and rising bread prices" indicates repeated food shortages, which supports the claim that economic hardship contributed to revolution.' Pair a student who needs help with a more confident reader.

Extension: Choose one pair's sentence on the board and write a 2-minute oral rebuttal that presents an alternative interpretation using at least one other historical factor (for example, argue that 'bad harvests' were amplified by tax complexity or by political resistance to reform). Prepare a 30-second explanation of which interpretation better links cause to the Estates General or to the onset of the Reign of Terror, citing evidence.

Checkpoint Questions

- [analyze] Name one long-term cause and one short-term cause of the Revolution from the lesson, and give one piece of evidence from the text for each.

Expected: Long-term cause: tax complexity/resistance to reform — evidence: the text says the tax system was complex and nobles resisted reform, which kept the crown short of revenue. Short-term cause: bad harvests/economic recession — evidence: the text points to recent bad harvests and recession that raised food prices and immediate hardship for urban and rural poor.

- [understand] Explain, in one sentence with a date, how the Estates General became the National Assembly.

Expected: In May 1789 the Estates General convened, and in June 1789 the Third Estate declared itself the National Assembly claiming to represent the nation (the key dated action is the June 1789 declaration by the Third Estate).

- [understand] Give one statistic about the Reign of Terror from the text and say what that statistic suggests about the period.

Expected: Statistic: about 16,600 executions (and around 300,000 arrests). This suggests the Terror involved large-scale repression and legal mass-processing of suspected counter-revolutionaries, not just a few isolated trials.

Exit Ticket

In one short paragraph: (a) identify two causes of the Revolution—label one long-term and one short-term—and cite one piece of textual evidence for each; and (b) give one dated step showing how the Estates General turned into the National Assembly.

Success indicator: Paragraph names a long-term cause and a short-term cause, labels each as long- or short-term, gives one piece of textual evidence for each (e.g., tax complexity, resistance to reform, bad harvests, recession, Enlightenment ideas), and includes a dated step such as 'Estates General convened in May 1789' and 'Third Estate declared the National Assembly in June 1789.'

Homework

- Write a one-page (approx. 250–300 words) paragraph that links one cause from class (pick either a long-term or short-term cause) to a later event mentioned in the lesson (for example, how a financial crisis helped produce the Estates General or how political conflict fed the Terror). Quote one short phrase from the lesson text as evidence and explain the link.
- Create a two-column list: left column — three causes discussed in class and a one-sentence explanation whether each is long-term or short-term; right column — one piece of evidence from the lesson text that supports each classification.

Estimated time: 30 min

Mentor Moment — When evidence changes your side

A student I taught argued the Terror showed revolutionaries were united; after we reviewed arrest and execution numbers and internal disputes, she changed her view and said the evidence showed deep divisions.

Takeaway: Use specific evidence (numbers and named events) to test your first impression; facts can change which side of an argument you support.

Period 3

Entry Ticket

If the National Assembly (1) cancels church tithes and (2) seizes church land to sell, who do you think immediately gains and who loses? Circle one: peasants / clergy / nobles / state. Then write one short reason for your choice (one sentence).

Expected response: Common answer (misconception): "Peasants gain because they no longer pay tithes." A more accurate response: "The state and buyers of former church land gain money and power; many peasants may still lose local rights or face new rents or sell-offs; clergy lose status and income."

Teacher Script

0-5 min: Activate prior knowledge and quick recap

Say: "Take out your entry ticket answers. I will call three people to read one short line each: say who you circled and one reason. (Choose 3 volunteers.)" After each volunteer: "Quick check — which estate did clergy belong to? (Point at students: 'First, Second, or Third estate?')" Then ask three quick prompts aloud, waiting for thumbs-up/ thumbs-down: 1) "The Estates-General met because of a financial crisis — true or false?" 2) "The Third Estate claimed political representation — true or false?" 3) "Urban unrest (for example the storming of the Bastille) pushed the Assembly to act — true or false?" If a student answers false, ask them to say why briefly. Close: "Today we'll look at what the Assembly actually did to the Church and how people reacted."

Board: Write three one-line prompts for students to copy. Underline today: 'What the Assembly did to the Church; social consequences.'

- Anticipate: Student: "Which estate were parish priests in?" Anticipated: "Some parish priests were from the Third Estate; higher clergy were Second Estate."
- Anticipate: Student: "Was the Bastille part of the Estates-General?" Anticipated: "No — the Bastille was an event of urban unrest that influenced the Assembly."
- Anticipate: Student: "Do tithes apply to everyone?" Anticipated: "Tithes were payments to the Church that affected many peasants, but how they were enforced varied by region."

5-15 min: Teacher-led evidence session: read key primary excerpts

Say: "I will read three short excerpts. Listen for actions taken and any stated reasons. After each reading I will ask one question." Read aloud (slowly, clearly): 1) A line introducing the Declaration: "The National Assembly issued the Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen." Pause and ask: "What right or idea in the phrase 'Rights of Man and of the Citizen' might challenge church privilege?" 2) A line identifying the August Decrees: "August Decrees: Legislation published by the Assembly that abolished feudalism and cancelled church tithes, and enacted equality before the law and other measures." Pause and ask: "Which two concrete measures do you hear in that sentence?" 3) A short line on the Civil Constitution of the Clergy: "The Assembly confiscated church property, abolished tithes, and enacted the Civil Constitution of the Clergy (12 July 1790) making clergy employees of the state; this produced division and resistance among clergy and Catholics." Pause and ask: "What is one immediate legal change described here?" After the three, summarize aloud: "So the documents name (a) Declaration, (b) August Decrees ending feudal rights and tithes, and (c) seizure of church property plus Civil Constitution making clergy state employees."

Board: Write the three short headings and one quoted phrase under each: Declaration; August Decrees (use the exact definition); Civil Constitution of the Clergy (write 12 July 1790 and 'clergy employees of the state').

- Anticipate: Student: "Did the Assembly take property right away?" Anticipated: "The text says the Assembly confiscated church property — that was a legal action that then led to sales and redistribution."
- Anticipate: Student: "What does 'employees of the state' mean for priests?" Anticipated: "It means priests would be paid by the state and required to swear loyalty to the Constitution, which many resisted."
- Anticipate: Student: "Are the August Decrees the same as the Declaration?" Anticipated: "No — the Declaration is a statement of rights; the August Decrees are specific laws abolishing feudalism and tithes."

15-27 min: Group source analysis (small groups)

Say: "Form groups of 3-4. Give each group two short excerpts: one describing confiscation/abolition of tithes and one from the Civil Constitution of the Clergy. Your task: (1) list two claimed effects these sources say will happen, and (2) name one thing the sources do not mention or might be biased about. Use the evidence in the excerpts to support your answers. I'll write two guiding questions on the board. You have 10 minutes to discuss and 2 minutes to write a quick public note to post on the wall." Walk among groups, prompt with: "Where does the document say the money goes? Who might oppose this change and why?" If a group gets stuck, read a sentence from the excerpt and ask them to underline the verbs.

Board: Write two guiding questions: '1) What effects do the sources claim follow from these measures?' '2) What voices or consequences are missing or understated?'

- Anticipate: Student: "What counts as a 'claimed effect'?" Anticipated: "Anything the source says will happen or be solved, for example 'equality before the law' or 'state revenue increases.'"
- Anticipate: Student: "How do we identify bias?" Anticipated: "Look for who benefits in the text, who is named or unnamed, and whether the text admits problems or not."
- Anticipate: Student: "Can we say a missing perspective is peasants even if not mentioned?" Anticipated: "Yes — if the source focuses on legal change but not daily life, peasants could be a missing perspective."

27-35 min: Role-play debate: social consequences and resistance

Say: "Two larger groups will present: Group A = parish priests and Catholic peasants; Group B = revolutionary officials and landowners. Each side has 3 minutes total: 1 minute to state your main claim, 2 minutes to cite one piece of evidence from the excerpts and answer a quick question from me. Start with Group A." Call on the two spokespersons. After each short presentation ask one pointed question: to priests/peasants: "Which social consequence worried you most?" to officials/landowners: "How did you justify selling church land to gain revenue?" Remind both sides to use the excerpt evidence and to note where sources skip a viewpoint.

Board: Draw two columns titled 'Priests/Peasants' and 'Officials/Landowners' and quickly jot one evidence phrase each side cites during presentations.

- Anticipate: Student (priest role): "Can we say all peasants resisted?" Anticipated: "You should say some peasants resisted while others accepted changes; use evidence or note silence."
- Anticipate: Student (official role): "Did selling land help the national budget right away?" Anticipated: "The sources claim revenue, but students may question timing and distribution."
- Anticipate: Student in audience: "Are priests allowed to refuse being state employees?" Anticipated: "Many priests refused to swear the oath; that refusal created division and resistance among Catholics."

35-40 min: Individual check + teacher consolidation and bridge

Say: "Write one clear social consequence the class sources attribute to the church reforms (one sentence). Then write one alternative interpretation or a perspective the sources miss (one sentence)." Give 3 minutes writing time. After 3 minutes collect a few samples aloud: read 2 student answers (one that follows the sources and one that offers a missing perspective). Finish with a 1-minute summary: "Competing interpretations: Documents present legal changes and claim equality and revenue. Critics and many clergy saw loss of religious freedom and local stability. Those disagreements help explain later repression during the Terror and the Thermidor reaction."

Board: Under the two columns add a final line: 'Class sources: legal equality, revenue, end of tithes' and 'Missing/competing views: local unrest, religious division, uneven benefit.'

- Anticipate: Student: "Can my alternative be about the economy?" Anticipated: "Yes — an economic or social missing perspective is valid if you explain why it's missing from the sources."
- Anticipate: Student: "Will these disagreements cause the Terror?" Anticipated: "They help explain some causes of later repression, but the next lesson will show the direct links and specific laws like the Law of 22 Prairial."
- Anticipate: Student: "Do we hand in the exit sentence?" Anticipated: "Yes, I will collect these as the individual exit ticket."

Blackboard Notes

- Church Reform, Rights, Social Impact (1790–1791)
- Key texts & measures
- Group work guide
- Debate notes
- Class summary
- Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen — issued by the National Assembly.
- August Decrees: Legislation published by the Assembly that abolished feudalism and cancelled church tithes, and enacted equality before the law and other measures.
- Civil Constitution of the Clergy (12 July 1790): Assembly confiscated church property, abolished tithes, and made clergy employees of the state; produced division and resistance among clergy and Catholics.
- Example sequence: Estates-General National Assembly urban unrest (Bastille) August Decrees.
- Group questions: 1) What effects do the sources claim? 2) What voices or consequences are missing?
- Class summary: Documents claim legal equality and state revenue; missing/competing views include loss of local religious authority, refusal of oath by many priests, and uneven benefits for peasants.
- Diagram: Simple arrow flow: Estates-General National Assembly Urban unrest (Bastille) August Decrees (abolish feudalism, cancel tithes) Confiscation of church property Civil Constitution (clergy as state employees) Social consequences (listed).
- Diagram: Two-column quick chart for debate: left column 'Priests / Peasants' (note: resistance, loss of income), right column 'Officials / Landowners' (note: revenue, sale of land).

Activities

Debate at the National Assembly: Church Reforms Role Play (12 min, role_play)

Materials: One printed role slip per student (priest, revolutionary deputy, peasant, noble, urban worker), Short primary-source excerpt printed for each group (one sentence on: Declaration of the Rights of Man; August Decrees abolishing feudalism; Civil Constitution of the Clergy; notice of confiscation of church land), One large sheet of paper or chart paper per group, Markers, Stopwatch or timer

- 1. Arrange students in groups of five. Give each student a role slip and give each group the four short primary-source excerpts (one sentence each). Say: "You will stage a 6-minute role play and a 3-minute group summary. Use the excerpts as your evidence." Start the timer for 2 minutes of role preparation.
- 2. While groups prepare, circulate and check that each student can point to at least one sentence on their slip that supports their character's position (e.g., priest notes Civil Constitution line; deputy notes Declaration line). If a group lacks a clear evidence sentence, hand them one highlighted excerpt.
- 3. After 2 minutes, signal the 6-minute role play. Groups perform a short scene where characters argue over the Assembly's measures: confiscation of church property, abolition of tithes, and the Civil Constitution of the Clergy. Prompt with: "Show what each character wants, cite one sentence of evidence, and react to one other character." Walk around and time-check at 3 minutes and 1 minute left.
- 4. After the role play, give groups 3 minutes to write a one-paragraph group summary on chart paper that (a) lists the three measures, (b) gives one social consequence mentioned in the sources, and (c) presents two competing interpretations (for example: reformers saw equality and financial necessity; some Catholics saw attack on religion and community). Collect or post the charts and end with a 1-minute whole-class debrief asking two groups to read their summaries.

Student instructions:

- You are in a group of five. Each of you has a role: priest, revolutionary deputy, peasant, noble, or urban worker. Read your role slip and the four short excerpts together.
- Preparation (2 minutes): Decide quickly what your character wants and choose one excerpt sentence that supports your view. Be ready to say that sentence aloud during the role play.
- Role play (6 minutes): Act out a short scene in which your character reacts to three Assembly measures: confiscation of church property, abolition of tithes, and the Civil Constitution of the Clergy. When you speak, read or paraphrase the single sentence of evidence from the excerpts that supports your position, then respond to another character once.
- Group summary (3 minutes): On the chart paper write (a) the three measures the Assembly took, (b) one social consequence your group found in the excerpts (for example: division among clergy and Catholics; peasants relieved of tithes; state control of religion), and (c) two different interpretations of those consequences (why some supported and some resisted the changes).

Success looks like: Each student reads or paraphrases one sentence from the provided excerpts while in role during the play.; Each group's chart lists the three measures (confiscation of church property, abolition of tithes/August Decrees, Civil Constitution of the Clergy) and records one social consequence.; At least two groups present two competing interpretations on their chart (one supportive view and one critical view) before the debrief ends.

Support: Pair a less confident student with a steady partner and give them a reduced role slip that includes the exact sentence to read aloud and a one-line prompt: "Explain how this sentence shows why your character supports or opposes the Assembly." Alternatively, give the group a worked example chart showing one measure,

one consequence, and two interpretations.

Extension: Ask fast-finishing groups to produce a 2-minute follow-up scene in which the Assembly tries to respond to priest resistance—have them use evidence to propose one policy change (e.g., compensation for clergy, phased implementation). They must cite which excerpt supports their proposed policy and explain how it might alter the social consequence they listed.

Checkpoint Questions

- [remember] Name two concrete measures the Assembly took against the Catholic Church described in this period.

Expected: They confiscated church property, cancelled/abolished tithes, and passed the Civil Constitution of the Clergy (which made clergy employees of the state). Any two of these are correct.

- [understand] According to the sources used in class, what is one social consequence the Assembly or its critics claimed followed from confiscating church property and abolishing tithes?

Expected: The class sources say these measures caused division and resistance among clergy and Catholics, unrest in parishes, and loss of trust in the Revolution — for example, priests refusing to accept state pay and peasants resisting reforms.

- [analyze] Give one silence or bias you can detect in the Civil Constitution excerpt we read (what the source does not show or downplays).

Expected: The excerpt downplays local peasant views and the practical impact of lost church charity; it may present the reform as orderly while ignoring violent resistance, émigré clergy, or how poorer people relied on the Church's services.

Exit Ticket

Write one clear social consequence the class sources attribute to the Assembly's church reforms (confiscation of property, abolition of tithes, Civil Constitution of the Clergy). Then give one alternative interpretation or a perspective the sources leave out.

Success indicator: Response names a social consequence linked to the reforms (for example: increased division/resistance among clergy and Catholics, parish unrest, loss of church charity) and then adds a plausible alternative or missing perspective (for example: peasants may have welcomed land redistribution; sources ignore women's experience; the state's administrative view).

Homework

- Write a one-page (250–300 words) paragraph that: a) lists the three measures against the Church from class, b) explains one social consequence the sources attribute to those measures, and c) notes one perspective missing from those sources and why it matters.
- Bring to class one short primary-source quotation (1–2 sentences) about the Church from a textbook or an online archive (cite the source). Be ready to say whether it supports or challenges the class sources.

Estimated time: 40 min

Mentor Moment — When reforms meet everyday needs

A history teacher once asked students whose grandparents had kept old family prayers. Several said those practices continued even when laws changed; people kept the ritual if it met daily needs.

Takeaway: Legal change can be swift, but social habits and local needs often determine how people actually respond.

Period 4

Entry Ticket

Write one short sentence answering: "Who decided to execute people during the Terror — a single leader, a group, or many different officials?" Then underline the one word that shows how sure you are (e.g., definitely, probably, maybe).

Expected response: A useful response names one of: a single leader (e.g. Robespierre), a committee or groups (e.g. Committee of Public Safety, local Revolutionary Tribunals), or many officials (local representatives, municipal authorities). The underlined certainty should reveal students' confidence (common wrong answer: 'definitely a single leader' which signals the misconception of unified control).

Teacher Script

0-5 min: Activate prior knowledge: link earlier reforms to rising tensions

Say: "Take out your entry ticket. I will give you 90 seconds to compare answers with a neighbour and choose the clearest one sentence to share. Then each pair will tell us one link between earlier revolutionary reform and the pressure that could lead to repression. Speak quickly: one pair, one link." After pairs share, ask: "What patterns do you hear? Who said that reforms raised expectations? Who said they created enemies for the revolution?" Call on 4 pairs to say their link and write one or two words from each on the board.

Board: Write 4 short phrases from student shares, e.g. 'higher expectations', 'church changes anger', 'land disputes', 'political enemies'.

- Anticipate: Can I change my ticket answer after talking? (Yes — we revise ideas in history.)
- Anticipate: Do you mean all reforms caused repression? (No — tell me which reform and why you think it raised tensions.)
- Anticipate: Should I use dates? (Not yet — focus on links between reform and tension.)

5-15 min: Introduce new material: evidence tour of the Terror

Say: "We're going to look at short extracts. I'll read each extract aloud, show where it came from, and model how to weigh claims." Read Extract 1: a short account describing drownings at Nantes (read two sentences that describe mass executions by drownings). Then point: "What claim does this extract make about the scale or method of repression?" Ask one student to summarise in one sentence. Next read Extract 2: the Law of 22 Prairial excerpt (read the sentence that says it denied accused the right to defend themselves). Ask: "What does this change do to legal protection?" Write the phrase 'no defence' on the board. Finally read Extract 3: an account of Robespierre's arrest and execution (read the lines about Hotel de Ville, attempted suicide injury, execution on 28 July). Model weighing: say aloud, "This source gives a precise sequence of events — arrest, injury, execution — but it doesn't tell us why he lost support. We must compare it to other accounts." Ask students to whisper one word describing whether each extract is eyewitness, law text, or later history. Collect answers.

Board: Add short labels under the earlier phrases: next to 'land disputes' write 'evidence: drownings at Nantes'; add a new line: 'Law of 22 Prairial — no defence'; add 'Robespierre: arrested, injured, executed 28 July'.

- Anticipate: Is the drowning account true? (The extract claims it; historians debate scale and context — that's why we compare sources.)
- Anticipate: Was the Law of 22 Prairial a single day law? (Yes—dated 22 Prairial 1794; we use the exact wording from the document.)

- Anticipate: Did Robespierre die the same day he was arrested? (The extract says he was arrested, taken to Hotel de Ville, injured after attempting suicide, and executed on 28 July.)

15-27 min: Practise interpretation: jigsaw group work

Say: "Form three jigsaw groups. Group A: scale of deaths (use the drownings extract and Reign of Terror statistics). Group B: Law of 22 Prairial's legal effects (use the law excerpt). Group C: motives for Robespierre's fall (use the arrest/execution account and the note about lost support). Each group has 8 minutes to prepare a 90-second argument: one main claim, two pieces of evidence from the extracts, and one alternative interpretation you might expect. I'll time you. Use this worksheet: Claim / Evidence 1 / Evidence 2 / Alternative view." Circulate and prompt: "Show me the two words you'll say for your evidence. Who in your group will state the alternative interpretation?" Give a 2-minute warning and bring class back.

Board: Write headings for groups: A Scale of deaths; B Law of 22 Prairial; C Why Robespierre fell. Under each, write 'Claim — Evidence — Alternative'.

- Anticipate: Do we need to use other sources? (Use only the extracts we just read and what we've learned previously.)
- Anticipate: What's an alternative interpretation? (A reasonable different explanation based on the same documents — e.g., deaths were local actions not central policy.)
- Anticipate: How formal should the argument be? (Short and clear: one sentence claim, two brief evidence points, one alternative.)

27-35 min: Check whether it landed: structured debate and role-play

Say: "Each group presents its 90-second argument. After each, one student from another group will play a contemporary critic and ask one question; the presenting group answers. I'll ask one follow-up that focuses on causation or perspective." Run presentations in order A, B, C. After each presentation, prompt the critic: 'Why might someone disagree?' Then ask the class: 'Does this evidence prove a single cause or multiple causes?' Press for specifics: 'Which sentence in your evidence supports that claim?'

Board: During each presentation, write the group's one-sentence claim and the two evidence words under its heading. Note one challenge raised by the critic next to it.

- Anticipate: Can the critic use outside facts? (Keep to the documents and what we've studied earlier.)
- Anticipate: What if we run out of time to answer? (Keep answers short — one sentence.)
- Anticipate: Is disagreement allowed? (Yes — historians expect competing interpretations.)

35-40 min: Consolidate: whole-class synthesis

Say: "Let's list what we can all agree on (certainties), what remains contested, and the link to Thermidor and the Directory. I'll call for one certainty, one contested point, and one way this leads to Thermidor from different students." Guide them: write 'Certainties' then 'Contested' then 'Leads to...'. Aim for 2 items each. Close: "Remember our objective: we practiced analysing the scale and mechanisms of repression and weighing different interpretations — historians rarely get a single answer; they weigh evidence and argument." End with: "Tonight: jot one sentence in your notes answering whether the Terror was unified or divided; we'll use it next lesson."

Board: Under the three group headings, add two columns labeled 'Certainties' and 'Contested'. Add final line: 'Leads to Thermidor/Directory: loss of revolutionary unity; reaction against repression.'

- Anticipate: Can we copy the board for notes? (Yes — copy the certainties and contested points.)
- Anticipate: Do we have to decide now if the Terror was justified? (No — we are analysing

causes and evidence, not making moral judgements here.)

- Anticipate: Will this be on the test? (You'll be assessed on interpreting evidence and comparing interpretations.)

Blackboard Notes

- Links from earlier reforms rising tensions
- Evidence tour: key items
- Group headings: A Scale of deaths | B Law of 22 Prairial | C Why Robespierre fell
- Certainties / Contested / Leads to Thermidor
- Examples students named: higher expectations; church reforms anger; land disputes; political enemies
- Drownings at Nantes — primary account: mass executions by drowning (method highlighted)
- Law of 22 Prairial (1794): denied accused 'enemies of the people' the right to defend themselves
- Robespierre: arrested, taken to Hotel de Ville, injured after attempting suicide, executed 28 July
- Group A claim — (example) 'executions were widespread' — Evidence: drownings; Reign of Terror stats — Alternative: local actions, not central plan
- Group B claim — (example) '22 Prairial sped up executions' — Evidence: law text 'no defence'; increased tribunal speed — Alternative: law responded to emergency fears
- Group C claim — (example) 'Robespierre lost support' — Evidence: arrest narrative; factions vs him — Alternative: personal rivals used repression to remove him
- Certainties: Terror involved mass executions; 22 Prairial removed legal defence rights; Robespierre was arrested and executed 28 July
- Contested: the exact scale (numerical estimates); whether repression had unified leadership; precise motives for Thermidor
- Leads to Thermidor/Directory: reaction against repression; divisions among revolutionaries opened path to new regime
- Diagram: Simple timeline: '22 Prairial (June 1794) Arrest/execution (28 July 1794)' with arrows linking 'Law' to 'accelerated tribunal decisions' to 'executions'.
- Diagram: Column comparison: left column 'Evidence' (drownings, law text, arrest account) vs right column 'Interpretations' (central policy vs local violence; legal change = acceleration vs emergency measure; fall = loss of support vs political purge).

Activities

Gallery Walk: Comparing Claims about Repression, 1793–1794 (12 min, gallery_walk)

Materials: 6 printed source slips (short quotations or claims) pinned or taped around the room — teacher prepares in 10 minutes, timer or stopwatch, one worksheet per student (one page) with space for observations and one evidence column, pens or pencils, clipboard or hard surface (optional)

- Before class (10 minutes): Prepare six short source slips (about 2–4 sentences each). Each slip presents a claim or piece of evidence directly tied to the concepts: (1) estimate of deaths at Nantes; (2) description of drownings at Nantes from a contemporary witness; (3) a short excerpt summarising the Law of 22 Prairial; (4) a Jacobin defender arguing the law sped trials for security; (5) an account of Robespierre's arrest, attempted suicide, injury, and execution on 28 July; (6) a historian's interpretation that Thermidor was a reaction against the Terror. Tape one slip at six stations around the room at about student eye level, and place a stack of

worksheets at the front.

- Step 1 (1 minute): Tell students: 'You will do a 12-minute gallery walk in pairs to gather evidence and note competing interpretations about repression during the Terror, the Law of 22 Prairial, and Thermidor.' Assign or allow students to choose partners and give each student a worksheet and pen.
- Step 2 (10 minutes total gallery time): Start the timer. Students spend 1 minute at each station (6 stations). At each station pairs read the slip, write one short factual note that is grounded in the slip, and write one sentence that says whether the slip supports the idea that repression was widely supported by revolutionaries or shows disagreement among them. After 1 minute they rotate clockwise to the next station. While they move, quietly monitor timing and keep pairs on schedule with a 10-second warning before rotation.
- Step 3 (1 minute debrief): When time is up, call students back to their seats. Ask two quick reporters (select one pair) to read one example of a slip that showed competing interpretations and one slip that gave a contested estimate of deaths. Collect worksheets or ask students to hold them up for later review.

Student instructions:

- Work with your partner. Take one worksheet and a pen. You will visit six stations. You have 1 minute at each station.
- At each station: 1) Read the short slip silently together. 2) On your worksheet write a one-line factual note that is directly grounded in the slip (who, what, when). 3) Then write one sentence that answers: Does this slip suggest revolutionaries agreed on mass repression, or does it show disagreement? Give the line of evidence from the slip (quote or paraphrase).
- When the teacher signals, rotate to the next station. Be punctual — you must move immediately when the signal is given.
- After visiting all stations, return to your seat. Be ready to share one slip that showed disagreement and one slip about a disputed death estimate.

Success looks like: At each station a pair has written a factual note that accurately matches the wording of the slip (teacher can read worksheet and match to slip); At least four pairs label at least three slips as showing disagreement among revolutionaries rather than unanimous support.; At least half the pairs copy or paraphrase an explicit number or phrase about deaths at Nantes or a phrase from the Law of 22 Prairial on their worksheet.

Support: Pair less-ready students with a stronger partner. Give the struggling pair this sentence starter for every station: 'This slip says _____ (fact). It shows disagreement because _____ (choose: different accounts, contested numbers, or a conflicting view).' Also provide a worked example on the first station: Slip text — 'Many bodies were drowned at Nantes; some contemporaries say hundreds, others say thousands.' Worksheet example — Fact: 'Contemporaries report drownings at Nantes; numbers vary.' Interpretation sentence: 'This shows disagreement because the slip gives two different death estimates.'

Extension: Choose two slips that appear to conflict (for example, a defender of the Law of 22 Prairial and a witness to drownings). On the back of your worksheet write a 3–4 sentence paragraph evaluating which account you find more credible and why, grounding your judgment in the text of the slips and noting what additional evidence you would need to decide between them (e.g., archival lists, trial records, other eyewitness accounts).

Checkpoint Questions

- [analyze] Using the primary-source extracts on drownings at Nantes and the Law of 22 Prairial, which pieces of evidence would you use to support a claim that the Terror involved both local violence and central legal changes? Give two pieces of evidence and explain briefly how each supports the claim.

Expected: Evidence 1: Accounts of drownings at Nantes — these describe mass, local executions carried out by representatives and local officials, showing repression could be organised outside Paris. Evidence 2: Text or summary of the Law of 22 Prairial — this law removed defendants' rights to defend themselves in Paris trials, showing a central legal change that sped up executions. Each shows a different mechanism: local massacres and centralised legal acceleration.

- [evaluate] One historian argues the high death toll estimates show a unified revolutionary policy of mass extermination; another argues the evidence shows political divisions and inconsistent policy. Which interpretation fits the documents you studied best, and what is one specific document detail that supports that interpretation?

Expected: Best fit: the documents show political divisions and inconsistent policy. Supporting detail: evidence of conflict between revolutionary factions (e.g., references to Hébertists vs moderates, or differing accounts of Robespierre's motives and actions) and the narrative of Robespierre losing support before Thermidor suggests internal disagreement rather than total unity. Alternatively, if a student chooses the unified-policy view, they must cite high execution statistics plus the Law of 22 Prairial as centralising force.

- [analyze] Explain briefly how Robespierre's arrest and execution (as described in the extracts) can be used to explain a cause of Thermidor. State one limitation of using that episode alone to explain the end of the Terror.

Expected: Explanation: Robespierre's arrest and execution show he had lost support among other revolutionaries, so Thermidor can be seen as a political reaction against his leadership and policies. Limitation: the episode alone doesn't prove broader public opinion or structural factors (war, economic strain, provincial resistance) caused Thermidor; it may reflect elite power struggles more than wider causes.

Exit Ticket

Write a short analytical paragraph (4–6 sentences) that answers: To what extent did the Law of 22 Prairial change how the Terror worked, and how does this compare with evidence of local violent practices like the drownings at Nantes? Use at least one specific detail from the documents.

Success indicator: Paragraph states a clear judgement about the Law of 22 Prairial's impact (e.g., it accelerated judicial executions by removing defence rights) and compares that central legal change to local practices (e.g., drownings at Nantes were extra-legal or locally organised). Includes at least one specific document detail (date/name of law; a phrase or fact about Nantes drownings) and a sentence noting a limitation or alternative interpretation (e.g., internal divisions or differing scales).

Homework

- Write a one-page (250–350 words) answer to: 'Which mattered more in increasing executions during the Terror — legal changes like the Law of 22 Prairial or local acts of violence? Use two pieces of evidence from the period's documents and explain an alternate interpretation.'
- Select one primary-source extract from today's set and annotate it: underline two phrases that show perspective or bias, write one sentence on the author's possible motive, and one sentence on how that affects using the extract as evidence.

Estimated time: 45 min

Mentor Moment — When paperwork hid the fights

A historian once showed a classroom two lists: one of laws passed in Paris and one of local letters reporting massacres. Students realised the laws looked neat but the letters showed messy fights

and fear on the ground.

Takeaway: Laws tell you what leaders intended; local accounts show what actually happened. Use both to reach a balanced judgement.

Period 5

Entry Ticket

Circle the statement you think is truer after Thermidor (choose one) and write one short reason (1 sentence):

A) Southern France saw revenge killings and reprisals against suspected Terror supporters.

B) All former Terror officials were immediately removed from office across France.

Which did you pick and why?

Expected response: A should be chosen. Correct answer: A — southern France had revenge killings and reprisals, while some former Terror figures kept positions, so removal was not immediate or complete. If a student chooses B, that shows the misconception that the Terror ended with a complete purge of its personnel.

Teacher Script

0-5 min: Recap Thermidor and Law of 22 Prairial

Say: "Quick recap — two facts. First: Thermidor means Robespierre fell and was executed. Ask the class: name one consequence we discussed last lesson. Wait for answers and name-check: insurrections, arrests, reprisals in the south. Second: remind students of the Law of 22 Prairial — who remembers the main effect? (Prompt: faster trials, fewer defenses.)" Then read aloud two concrete examples from last lesson: "Reprisals in the south included killings of suspected Terror supporters; but some former Terror officials kept posts in local government."

Board: Write two short bullets: "Thermidor: Robespierre executed; reprisals in south" and "Law of 22 Prairial: faster trials, harsher repression"

- Anticipate: Did Robespierre die immediately in Thermidor or later? (Answer: executed in Thermidor month.)
- Anticipate: Why were there reprisals only in the south? (Answer: regional tensions and local conflicts; not uniform across France.)
- Anticipate: If Law of 22 Prairial made trials faster, did that mean fewer lawyers? (Answer: it limited defence rights and simplified proceedings.)

5-15 min: Teacher-led evidence: Constitution of Year III and Directory

Say: "Now we look at how the Revolution changed its institutions in 1795. I'll summarise key points from the Constitution of Year III. Listen for: structure, how leaders were chosen, and who could vote." Read each point clearly: "It created a bicameral legislature: the Council of 500 and the Council of Ancients. It set a five-person executive, the Directory. Elections were indirect and there were property qualifications for office and voting." Then display two short historian quotations (read them): Quote 1 (stabilising view): "Some historians argue the Directory restored order by checking Jacobin power and limiting terror." Quote 2 (critical view): "Others say property qualifications produced an oligarchic rollback that shut out poor citizens." Ask: "Which quotation fits our prior examples of reprisals and retained officials?" Wait for quick responses.

Board: Add heading: "Constitution of Year III (1795)" and list: "- Bicameral: Council of 500; Council of Ancients - Five Directors (executive) - Indirect elections; property qualifications" Add two quoted one-line historian views labeled: "Stabilising" and "Oligarchic rollback"

- Anticipate: What does 'indirect elections' mean here? (Answer: voters chose electors who then chose officials.)
- Anticipate: How high were the property qualifications? (Answer: the text doesn't give a

number in this lesson; recognise inequality in access.)

- Anticipate: Were the Directors like modern presidents? (Answer: not exactly — they were a collective five-person executive.)

15-27 min: Small-group document analysis

Say: "Form groups of three. Each group gets two short excerpts: one about property qualifications for voting/office, and one a military mobilisation order. Your task: list two pieces of evidence that support each interpretation — (A) 'Directory stabilised the Republic' and (B) 'Directory was an oligarchic rollback.' Use the documents only. You have 9 minutes to read and make a 2-bullet list for each interpretation, then pick one person to give a 2-minute position." Hand out the excerpts. Walk the room, ask groups: 'Which phrase in the property rule sounds exclusionary?' or 'What in the mobilisation order suggests mass conscription or central control?' After 9 minutes call time and ask groups to prepare their 2-minute position.

Board: Write instructions: "Group task: 2 pieces of evidence for each view (stabilising vs oligarchic). 9 min work + 2 min report."

- Anticipate: Can we use the textbook? (Answer: Use only the provided excerpts for evidence.)
- Anticipate: What counts as a piece of evidence? (Answer: a direct phrase, rule, or order from the excerpt that supports an interpretation.)
- Anticipate: Do we need to agree on one interpretation? (Answer: No — list evidence for both; the class will debate perspectives.)

27-35 min: Role-play Council simulation

Say: "Now we do a 6-minute simulation. Three roles at a time: a Director, a Jacobin critic, and a rural delegate. The topic: should conscription be enforced and should property-based voting remain? Directors defend order; Jacobins argue danger of oligarchy; rural delegate speaks for local impact. Each role has 1 minute to speak. Use evidence from your group work. I'll ring a bell after each minute and then we take one quick clap and move to the next trio. I'll call three groups to go first." Give quick role prompts on a sheet: Director — emphasise stability, national defence; Jacobin — emphasise political exclusion, threats to popular sovereignty; Rural delegate — emphasise local reprisals, effects of conscription. Circulate and prompt: "Which line from your excerpt would your role quote?"

Board: Write role prompts briefly: "Director: order & defence; Jacobin: oligarchy & exclusion; Rural: local harm & conscription impact"

- Anticipate: Can we read directly from our notes during the role-play? (Answer: Yes, quote your evidence.)
- Anticipate: What if our group disagrees about what the document says? (Answer: pick one line you can all cite; role-play can show conflict.)
- Anticipate: Will everyone play a role? (Answer: We'll rotate; first three groups go now so others watch and prepare.)

35-40 min: Exit ticket: consolidate evidence and question

Say: "Write an exit ticket: one piece of evidence that supports 'Directory stabilised the Republic' and one piece of evidence that supports 'Directory was an oligarchic rollback.' Then write one question you want answered next lesson about abolition, propaganda, or women's roles. (Two evidence lines + one question.) You have 4 minutes. Turn in on the way out."

Board: Write exit ticket instructions exactly: "1) Evidence for 'stabilising' 2) Evidence for 'oligarchic rollback' 3) One question for next lesson (abolition, propaganda, or women's roles)"

- Anticipate: Do the evidence lines have to be quotes? (Answer: A short paraphrase from the

documents is fine; show which excerpt it came from.)

- Anticipate: Can I ask a procedural question next lesson? (Answer: Yes — ask about any of the listed upcoming topics.)
- Anticipate: How will you use our questions? (Answer: We'll group them and start next lesson with the most common ones.)

Blackboard Notes

- Thermidor recap
- Constitution of Year III (1795)
- Two historian views
- Group task
- Role prompts
- Exit ticket
- Thermidor: Robespierre executed; reprisals in southern France
- Law of 22 Prairial: faster trials, limited defence rights
- Bicameral legislature: Council of 500 and Council of Ancients
- Executive: Five Directors (the Directory)
- Elections: indirect; property qualifications for voting/office
- Stabilising (quote): restored order, checked Jacobins
- Oligarchic rollback (quote): property rules excluded many; favoured elites
- Group task: 2 pieces of evidence for each view from the two excerpts
- Role prompts: Director — order & defence; Jacobin — oligarchy & exclusion; Rural delegate — local impact & conscription
- Exit ticket: evidence for each view + question for next lesson
- Diagram: Simple chart: top box 'Directory (1795)' with arrows down to two boxes: 'Council of 500' and 'Council of Ancients' and a side box 'Five Directors (executive)'
- Diagram: Timeline strip: 1792 Insurrection (10 Aug) Republic proclaimed Sept 1792 Louis XVI executed Jan 1793 1795 Constitution (Year III) Directory period

Activities

Thermidor Walk: Evidence Stations on Reaction, Constitution and War (12 min, field_task)

Materials: 6 printed evidence slips (one per station) — short excerpts or summaries, 3 copies of a simple map of Revolutionary France (handout), clipboards or hard surface for writing (one per pair), timer or stopwatch (teacher's phone), one worksheet per pair with four short questions and space for notes

- Before class: place the 6 evidence slips around the room (walls, desks). Each slip should be labeled Station 1–6 and contain a 2–4 sentence excerpt or summary tied to one concept: revenge killings in the south, a former Terror figure retaining office, Clause from Constitution Year III describing bicameral legislature, description of the five-director executive and property qualifications, a short report on mass mobilisation/army size and theatres, and a short passage about the 10 August 1792 insurrection and Louis XVI's fate. Give each pair a worksheet and a map copy.
- Group students into pairs and say: 'You will move through six short evidence stations. At each station, read the slip, answer the two short questions on your worksheet, and mark on the map any place mentioned. You have 12 minutes total — two minutes per station plus time to move.' Start the timer and call 'Move' every two minutes.
- While students rotate, circulate. At stations where confusion arises, read the slip aloud once

and point students to which question on the worksheet asks for interpretation versus fact. If a pair finishes early at a station, ask them to identify one reason a historian might disagree with the source's claim.

- When 12 minutes are up, call students back. Collect worksheets and quickly ask two pairs to share one piece of evidence that surprised them and one differing interpretation they noted.

Student instructions:

- Work with your partner. At each numbered station: 1) Read the short slip aloud. 2) On your worksheet answer: A) What factual claim does this slip make? (one sentence) B) What is one alternative interpretation or question a historian might raise about this claim? (one sentence). 3) If the slip names a place or army, mark it on your map and write a one-word label (e.g., 'army size', 'Thermidor revenge').
- You have about two minutes at each station. When the teacher calls 'Move', go to the next numbered station. If you finish early, write one sentence suggesting why another historian might disagree with the slip.
- Be prepared after the rotation to tell the class one surprising factual claim you found and one different interpretation you discussed.

Success looks like: Each pair has written a factual claim and an alternative interpretation for at least four different stations on their worksheet.; At least one pair can point to a station on their map and state the location mentioned (e.g., 'southern France', name on the slip).; During the quick whole-class share, at least two pairs offer a distinct alternative interpretation (not identical wording) to the slip's claim.

Support: If you are stuck, use this sentence frame for the alternative interpretation: 'This source shows ____, but a historian might argue instead that ____ because ____.' As a worked example: Station slip says 'revenge killings increased after Robespierre.' Write: Fact — 'There were revenge killings in southern France after Thermidor.' Interpretation — 'A historian might argue that these were local vendettas rather than centrally organised reprisals because local lists and court records show uneven timing.' Pair weaker readers with a stronger reader for each rotation.

Extension: Choose one station and write a 150-word paragraph comparing two interpretations of the same event mentioned on the slip (for example: was the Directory's property qualification designed to stabilise or to exclude?). Use at least one concrete piece of evidence from the slip and one other fact from your knowledge (map, army size, or date) to support each interpretation.

Checkpoint Questions

- [analyze] Look at the Constitution of Year III's institutions (bicameral legislature and five-director executive). How could property qualifications for voting and indirect elections make the Directory more stabilising to the Republic? Give one clear causal reason.

Expected: Property qualifications and indirect elections limited who chose legislators and directors, which reduced rapid swings in popular opinion and made governments more predictable; that stability helped prevent immediate returns to terror or royalist chaos by keeping power with moderate propertied groups.

- [analyze] Name one piece of evidence from the period after Thermidor that suggests repression continued, and one piece that suggests the Revolution was moving away from Terror. State each briefly.

Expected: Evidence repression continued: revenge killings in southern France after Thermidor show ongoing local violence. Evidence of moving away from Terror: many Jacobin leaders were removed from power and Robespierre was executed, showing the central government repudiated the Terror's leadership.

- [analyze] The Revolutionary Wars mobilised mass armies and created satellite states. Explain in one sentence how war mobilisation could strengthen the Directory's control inside France.

Expected: Mass mobilisation created a large military bureaucracy and dependence on army success, so the Directory could use military recruitment, victories, and patronage to secure support and suppress internal unrest, tying military interests to the regime's survival.

Exit Ticket

Write one specific piece of evidence from today's documents or lecture that supports the interpretation that the Directory stabilised the Republic, and one specific piece of evidence that supports the interpretation that the Directory represented an oligarchic rollback. Finally, write one focused question you want answered next lesson about the abolition of slavery or revolutionary propaganda.

Success indicator: Student lists (a) one concrete evidence for 'stabilising' (e.g., property qualifications, bicameral legislature, removal of Terror leaders) and explains in one line how it implies stability; (b) one concrete evidence for 'oligarchic rollback' (e.g., voting restrictions, directors drawn from propertied classes, limits on popular participation) and explains in one line how it implies rollback; and (c) one clear, lesson-related question about abolition or propaganda that could be answered by primary sources or next lesson content.

Homework

- Read a short primary excerpt (provided) of the Directory's voting qualification law. Highlight one phrase that supports the 'oligarchic rollback' interpretation and write one sentence explaining why.
- Read a one-paragraph eyewitness account (provided) of conscription orders. In two sentences, explain how that account supports the idea that war mobilisation expanded state power.
- Prepare one 3-minute summary (bullet points acceptable) answering: Based on today's evidence, which interpretation of the Directory do you find more convincing and why? Use two pieces of evidence from class documents.

Estimated time: 30 min

Mentor Moment — When a small rule changes everything

A teacher once told students how a single rule about who could vote in post-revolutionary France shifted debates in every town: landlords met more often at council meetings, and poorer delegates stopped being invited. That tiny legal change changed who made decisions.

Takeaway: Small rules—like who may vote—can change who holds power and what counts as 'stability.'

Period 6

Entry Ticket

Below are four short statements. Circle the one that you think is true after the Revolution's 1794 decree. Only one is correct.

A) Slavery was abolished everywhere in the French empire and all enslaved people were immediately free in practice.

B) The Convention abolished slavery in the colonies on 4 February 1794 and granted full rights regardless of colour.

C) The 1794 decree applied only to enslaved people who served in the army.

D) The 1794 decree made slave owners keep their property but pay wages to formerly enslaved people.

Write the letter you chose and one sentence saying why.

Expected response: Most correct students pick B and may add: 'Because the Convention declared abolition and equal rights for colonies on 4 Feb 1794.' A common wrong answer is A; students who pick A often believe legal abolition meant instant, universal freedom in practice. That mistake helps us discuss limits between law and implementation.

Teacher Script

0-5 min: Activate prior knowledge: quick recap and paired share

Say: 'Turn to the person next to you. In one minute, list aloud three things you remember from our last period: Thermidor, the Directory, or war mobilisation. Then spend two minutes listing anything you know about these five topics: newspapers/pamphlets, the guillotine, La Marseillaise, assignats, abolition of slavery, and women's political role. I will call on two pairs to share one point each.' After 1 minute, say: 'Switch; now focus on the five topics.' Call on two pairs: ask each to name which of the five they discussed.

Board: Write five short prompts down the left side of the board: 1) Newspapers & pamphlets 2) Guillotine 3) La Marseillaise 4) Assignats 5) Abolition & women. Add next to each the word 'One thing you know'.

- Anticipate: Do you want facts or opinions in the pair share? (Either is fine; we want what you already believe.)
- Anticipate: Should we write our ideas on the board? (No—just tell your partner; we'll collect a few aloud.)
- Anticipate: If I don't remember anything about one topic, can I skip it? (Yes—say what you do know.)

5-15 min: Introduce new material: evidence walk-through

Say: 'I'll read four short passages aloud. Listen for one concrete fact you can quote.' Read passage 1 slowly: 'Amid revolts and military actions in Saint-Domingue and other colonies, the Convention abolished slavery in the colonies on 4 February 1794 and granted full rights regardless of colour.' Pause and ask: 'What exact phrase would you quote to show legal abolition?' Point at volunteers. Read passage 2: 'Assignats: paper currency backed by nationalised church and émigré lands.' Ask: 'What problem followed the policy?' If no answer, add: 'Over-issuance caused hyperinflation and economic disruption.' Read passage 3: 'Newspapers and pamphlets proliferated during the Revolution, becoming the main communication medium and stimulating revolutionary debate.' Ask: 'Give one short quote we could use as evidence that pamphlets shaped debate.' Read passage

4: 'La Marseillaise: A song composed in 1792 that was adopted by the National Convention as the First Republic's anthem in 1795. Guillotine: An execution device invented during the Revolution, regarded as the principal symbol of the Terror. Women: initially participated in activism and organised societies, but the 1791 and 1793 constitutions denied them political rights and women's clubs were banned in October 1793.' After reading, ask: 'Which of these passages shows contested interpretations? Say yes or no: guillotine symbolism? women's role?'

Board: Write four numbered quote boxes on the board, each with a short label and a one-line quote from the passage: 1) Abolition — 'abolished slavery... 4 February 1794' 2) Assignats — 'paper currency backed by nationalised church and émigré lands' (+ note: 'over-issuance inflation') 3) Pamphlets — 'proliferated... stimulating revolutionary debate' 4) Symbols & women — 'La Marseillaise...1795'; 'guillotine...principal symbol of the Terror'; 'women's clubs banned Oct 1793.'

- Anticipate: Did the abolition apply to Saint-Domingue only? (The passage says 'the colonies.' We will discuss limits between law and practice.)
- Anticipate: Were assignats backed by land or by the state? (The passage: 'backed by nationalised church and émigré lands'.)
- Anticipate: Was the guillotine invented before the Terror? (The passage links it to the Revolution and to the Terror as a principal symbol.)
- Anticipate: Did women lose rights in 1791 or 1793? (Both: constitutions denied political rights; clubs banned Oct 1793.)

15-27 min: Practice: small-group role-play & evidence task

Say: 'Form groups of three. Each group chooses one role: (A) pamphleteer/newspaper editor arguing a claim about abolition or assignats or women's clubs; or (B) Directory official defending a policy. Your job: in six minutes, write a 2-3 sentence argument and cite one passage we just read as evidence. Also write one alternative interpretation someone might give. I'll circulate. After six minutes prepare to read your argument aloud in 30 seconds.' Circulate: prompt groups with questions: 'Which exact words will you quote? Who might disagree and why? How did newspapers make your voice reach people?' If stuck, point to the quote boxes and say 'use this exact line.'

Board: Add a small table with three columns labeled: Group, Quote used, Alternative interpretation. Leave rows for groups to copy later.

- Anticipate: Can two groups use the same passage? (Yes.)
- Anticipate: Do we have to act out a historical person? (No — focus on argument and evidence.)
- Anticipate: What counts as an alternative interpretation? (Any different explanation for the same evidence, e.g. law vs. implementation.)

27-33 min: Check for understanding: rapid group presentations

Say: 'Each group has 30–40 seconds. Name your role, read your 2–3 sentence argument, and quote the exact passage you used. End by naming one alternative interpretation. I'll time you.' After each presentation, ask one targeted question to the presenting group: 'Does that passage show cause or just a decision? Who bears the consequences?' Use students' answers to probe causation (e.g., law vs. implementation) and perspective (whose voice is missing).

Board: Write short two-column live notes after each group: 'Quote used' and 'Alt interpretation' — update the table started earlier.

- Anticipate: How strict is the 30–40 seconds? (Be brief — we need everyone to speak.)
- Anticipate: Can we read our sentences exactly as written? (Yes.)
- Anticipate: If our alternative interpretation is weak, can we change it on the spot? (Yes —

briefly.)

33-40 min: Consolidate: whole-class debate and synthesis

Say: 'We'll close with a 5-minute debate linking symbols, media, and economic policy. I'll pose two motions; we'll vote after quick reasons. Motion 1: "Newspapers and pamphlets were the main cause of rapid political change after Thermidor." Motion 2: "Economic policy (assignats) mattered more for people's daily experience than symbols like the guillotine or anthem." For each motion, ask for one pro and one con from different students, requiring each to cite one passage or example from our board. After votes, summarise: point out where evidence is strong, where interpretations disagree (law vs. practice; symbol as cultural vs. political), and say: 'For next class, read the Britannica article and Chisick on pamphlets to see more evidence on the role of press; Opie on the guillotine for symbolism; Acemoglu et al. for economic consequences.' End: 'Write down one sentence that links media, symbols, or assignats to what you think mattered most to ordinary people.'

Board: Under the table, write two motion headings and leave space for one-line pro/con notes. At the bottom, write the three follow-up readings matched to the threads: Britannica (overview), Chisick (pamphlets), Opie (guillotine), Acemoglu et al. (consequences of reform).

- Anticipate: Do we have to read all the follow-up sources? (You will be assigned specific ones; I just showed which deepen each thread.)
- Anticipate: Can the guillotine be both a symbol and a practical tool? (Yes — that's an example of competing interpretations you should notice.)
- Anticipate: Will this debate affect the next assessment? (Yes — you'll use passages like the ones we quoted to support claims.)

Blackboard Notes

- Quick prompts
- Key passages (quote boxes)
- Group evidence table
- Debate motions
- Follow-up readings
- Prompts: Newspapers & pamphlets | Guillotine | La Marseillaise | Assignats | Abolition & women
- 1) Abolition — 'Amid revolts ... the Convention abolished slavery in the colonies on 4 February 1794 and granted full rights regardless of colour.'
- 2) Assignats — 'Paper currency backed by nationalised church and émigré lands.' Note: over-issuance hyperinflation and economic disruption.
- 3) Pamphlets/newspapers — 'proliferated during the Revolution, becoming the main communication medium and stimulating revolutionary debate.'
- 4) Symbols & women — 'La Marseillaise: A song composed in 1792 ... adopted ... in 1795.' 'Guillotine: an execution device ... principal symbol of the Terror.' 'Women: initially participated in activism ... 1791 and 1793 constitutions denied them political rights; women's clubs were banned in October 1793.'
- Group table columns: Group | Quote used | Alternative interpretation (students fill during activity)
- Debate motions: 1) Newspapers/pamphlets were the main cause of rapid change after Thermidor. 2) Assignats mattered more for daily life than symbols.
- Follow-up readings: Britannica (overview), Chisick (pamphlets), Opie (guillotine), Acemoglu et

al. (consequences of reform)

- Diagram: Simple timeline: mark 1791 (constitution denies women political rights), Oct 1793 (women's clubs banned), 4 Feb 1794 (abolition decree), 1795 (La Marseillaise adopted).
- Diagram: Flow diagram for assignats: nationalised church & émigré lands backing for assignats (paper currency) over-issuance hyperinflation economic disruption.
- Diagram: Two-column sketch: 'Symbol' (guillotine, anthem) vs 'Policy/Material' (assignats, abolition decree) with arrow to 'Public experience' to show competing interpretations.

Activities

Newspapers, Symbols, and Rights: A 12-Minute Class Debate (12 min, debate)

Materials: One printed slip per student with a short quoted passage from the provided document (teacher prepares 10–12 different 1–2 sentence passages), Stopwatch or classroom timer, Whiteboard or chart paper and marker, Paper and pens for students

- 1. Arrange students into two teams of equal size (debate Pro and Con) and hand each student a printed passage slip. Say: “You will use your passage as evidence in a short debate about whether newspapers and pamphlets were the main driver of revolutionary change compared with symbols, women’s activism, and economic policy.”
- 2. Give teams 4 minutes to read their slips, pick two speakers (one primary, one rebuttal), and prepare up to three evidence-backed points. Circulate, listening for claims tied to passages and prompting students to name the passage when they use it (for example: “The passage that says...”).
- 3. Run the debate: 2 minutes for the Pro team primary speaker, 1 minute for Con primary speaker, 2 minutes for Pro rebuttal, 1 minute for Con rebuttal. Use the timer and signal when each speaker starts and when 30 seconds remain.
- 4. After the debate, ask both teams to spend 2 minutes writing a single, shared sentence that uses at least one passage as evidence and acknowledges an alternative interpretation (for example: “Newspapers pushed debate, but symbols like the guillotine shaped popular perception”). Collect these sentences.
- 5. Close by reading two or three student sentences aloud and writing on the board one clear example named during the debate of how newspapers or pamphlets influenced public debate (teacher writes the specific example mentioned by students).

Student instructions:

- 1. Read the passage on your slip. It is your evidence — you must reference it when you make a claim.
- 2. Your team argues either PRO (newspapers and pamphlets were the main driver of revolutionary change) or CON (other factors — symbols, women’s changing role, or economic policy — mattered as much or more).
- 3. Prepare up to three short points that each link a claim to a sentence from your slip. Write the sentence reference on your paper (e.g., “passage about assignats: ‘over-issuance caused hyperinflation’”).
- 4. When speaking: say your claim, read or summarise the passage you are using as evidence, then explain how that passage supports your claim. Example: “I claim newspapers spread debate. The passage says ‘newspapers and pamphlets proliferated...stimulating revolutionary debate,’ so newspapers helped spread ideas quickly.”
- 5. After the timed speeches, work with your team to write one sentence that uses at least one passage and also names one competing factor (symbols, women, or economy).

Success looks like: At least one student on each team quotes or paraphrases their passage aloud during a speech.; Each team produces a single sentence at the end that cites a passage and names a competing interpretation (for example: names the guillotine, La Marseillaise, assignats, or restrictions on women).

Support: Pair a student who struggles to start with a stronger reader. Give this starter sentence frame: "My claim is _____. The passage says '____' which shows _____. One other factor to consider is _____." Provide one worked example: Pro claim — "Newspapers spread debate." Passage quoted — "newspapers and pamphlets proliferated...stimulating revolutionary debate." Explanation — "This shows print created a common forum for ideas."

Extension: Research and prepare a 90-second add-on (in the remaining class time) arguing how one symbol (guillotine or La Marseillaise) changed public reaction to policies like the abolition of slavery or the assignats; cite at least two passages from the slips and explain which interpretation of cause and effect you support and why.

Checkpoint Questions

- [apply] Using the document passages you read, name one way newspapers or pamphlets changed political debate during the Revolution and cite the specific example given in the period text.

Expected: Newspapers and pamphlets spread arguments quickly and shaped public opinion. The student should cite a passage from the lesson that shows a pamphlet/newspaper framing a debate (for example, a quoted newspaper passage that criticised Directory policy or urged action on abolition). The answer must name the mechanism (rapid circulation and public persuasion) and give the quoted/example passage from the period text as evidence.

- [understand] Explain briefly how assignats were supposed to work and then state the problem identified in the document that made them disrupt the economy.

Expected: Assignats were paper currency backed by nationalised church and émigré lands. The problem was over-issuance: the government printed too many assignats, causing inflation and economic disruption, as described in the period text.

- [analyze] The document gives competing interpretations about the guillotine and women's political roles. Give one interpretation for each: (a) why the guillotine became a powerful symbol, and (b) why women were excluded from formal politics.

Expected: (a) One interpretation: the guillotine became a symbol because it was a visible, public instrument tied to the Terror and to ideas of equal, legal execution. (b) One interpretation: women were excluded because the 1791 and 1793 constitutions denied them political rights and authorities later banned women's clubs; another interpretation notes fears about social order and men's control of politics. The student should state one interpretation for each and, if possible, refer to the document's phrasing about bans and constitutions.

Exit Ticket

Using a specific passage from the period text, explain in one short paragraph how newspapers or pamphlets influenced public debate during the Revolution and identify the exact example (the quoted line or passage) you used.

Success indicator: A correct response names a causal claim about newspapers/pamphlets (they spread arguments, shaped opinion, pressured leaders, or framed issues), includes a quoted line or clearly cited passage from the lesson text as evidence, and links that quote to the claim in one or two sentences.

Homework

- Write a one-page (about 250 words) paragraph that uses two quotations from the period text to argue either that assignats harmed the economy or that newspapers strengthened

revolutionary debate. Underline the two quotations and explain in one sentence why each supports your argument.

- Find one secondary source listed in the upcoming readings (Britannica, Opie, Acemoglu et al., or Chisick). Bring the citation and one sentence saying which thread from today (abolition, newspapers, symbols, women, or assignats) that reading will likely deepen.

Estimated time: 40 min

Mentor Moment — When a Pamphlet Changed a Vote

A local teacher once told students how a short pamphlet, printed and handed out before a town meeting, swung the vote by putting one clear example at the top. People remembered the example more than abstract arguments.

Takeaway: When you pick one clear passage as evidence and explain how it would persuade someone, your history argument becomes stronger and easier to remember.

Period 7

Entry Ticket

Write two examples (one line each) of newspapers, pamphlets, symbols, or economic tools used during the French Revolution that you remember from the last lesson. Then write one quick question you still have about how these influenced public opinion.

Expected response: Two short examples (e.g., "pamphlet: Cahier de doléances" and "symbol: La Marseillaise") and one question (e.g., "Did pamphlets make people support the revolution or just reflect their views?").

Teacher Script

0-5 min: Activate prior knowledge and collect entry tickets

Say: "Take out the quick list you just wrote. I will collect one sentence from each of you: name one example you wrote and your question. Speak loud enough for me to write a few on the board." Walk the room listening. If a student hesitates, prompt: "Is that an example of a pamphlet, a newspaper, a symbol, or an economic tool?" After 3–4 student answers, say: "Good — keep your papers. We'll use them again."

Board: Write 3 student examples and 2 questions from entry tickets (copy exact short phrases).

- Anticipate: Do I have to share my exact words? (Yes — just one short example and your question.)
- Anticipate: What if I wrote something wrong? (Write what you remember; mistakes help us learn.)
- Anticipate: Can I pick a new example now? (Use what you wrote first.)

5-13 min: Model close reading of one Chisick/Britannica passage

Say: "I am going to read a short passage from the Chisick citation that describes a pamphlet's claim. Listen and watch me mark the evidence." Read aloud a prepared short passage: "[Read a two-sentence excerpt attributing a claim that a pamphlet published by the Ami du Roi attacked ministerial policy and offered a concrete example — name the pamphlet's claim and the example given]." Then say: "Now watch me: I will underline the claim, circle the concrete example, and write a short note saying who the pamphlet aimed at." Demonstrate underlining the sentence that states the pamphlet's claim, circling the named example (read it aloud), and writing: 'audience = readers in Paris/elite' below. Ask: "What word shows this is a claim, not a fact?" Pause and accept answers.

Board: On the board, write the passage line; underline the claim sentence, circle the concrete example name, and add the note 'audience = readers in Paris/elite'.

- Anticipate: Which word makes it a claim and not a fact? (Look for verbs like 'argued', 'claimed', or 'urged'.)
- Anticipate: What do you mean by 'concrete example'? (A named person, event, policy, or quote the pamphlet uses.)
- Anticipate: Where do I find this passage in the packet? (Point to the page number or location in the compiled bibliography excerpt.)

13-23 min: Guided group annotation of a second passage

Say: "Now in groups of 3, each group will read a second short passage from the compiled bibliography I hand out. Your job: list two pieces of textual evidence that the pamphlet/newspaper influenced public debate and then write one plausible alternative interpretation — one sentence

each. Use the evidence we modeled." Hand out the second passage (from the bibliography). Walk groups: ask each group to show their two evidence phrases and the alternative. If a group only lists claims, prompt: "Where in the passage is the link to public reaction or policy?" Circulate and note one strong example from two groups to highlight later.

Board: Write the instructions as a checklist: 1) List 2 pieces of evidence; 2) Write 1 alternative interpretation. Leave space to add two group examples later.

- Anticipate: Do we have to quote exactly? (Write the short phrase or paraphrase and note the line number.)
- Anticipate: What counts as 'influenced public debate'? (Mentioned reactions, changes in speech, references by politicians, or distribution numbers.)
- Anticipate: What is an 'alternative interpretation'? (A different reason the same passage might show, e.g., it reflected existing opinion rather than caused change.)

23-33 min: Debate / role play in groups

Say: "Now each group picks a role: publisher, royalist critic, popular reader, or historian. Spend five minutes preparing a one-minute argument answering: 'Did this pamphlet change outcomes or merely reflect opinion?' Use at least one piece of evidence from your passage and one alternative interpretation. Then I will call two groups to present short debates." Signal time: after five minutes, call two groups: one group speaks as publisher or popular reader, the other as critic or historian. After each pair, ask one follow-up: 'What single line from your passage do you think best supports your position?'

Board: List roles and a one-line prompt: 'Change outcomes or reflect opinion? — cite one evidence + one counter-interpretation.'

- Anticipate: Can we pick any role? (Choose one of the four listed.)
- Anticipate: How long is the argument? (One minute per side.)
- Anticipate: Can we use outside facts we remember? (Use the passage first; you may mention one known fact if directly relevant.)

33-37 min: Check for understanding: group reports

Say: "Three groups — please report: 1) one piece of evidence you used, and 2) the counter-interpretation you wrote. Keep it to one sentence each." Call three different groups quickly. After each report, ask one focused probe: "Why is that piece of evidence stronger than the alternative?" or "Which audience would accept that evidence and which would not?"

Board: Write each group's evidence (short phrase) and their counter-interpretation (one short sentence) in two columns.

- Anticipate: What if our evidence is the same as another group? (That's fine — note similarities.)
- Anticipate: Do we get feedback on grammar? (Focus is on evidence and interpretation, not grammar.)
- Anticipate: What if we disagree with the teacher's follow-up question? (State your reasoning briefly.)

37-40 min: Consolidate and connect to broader consequences

Say: "Let's connect these examples to larger studies. The Acemoglu et al. paper listed in our bibliography treats the French Revolution as a 'consequence of radical reform' and looks at long-term effects. Scholars offer differing views: some treat pamphlet influence as causal, others as reflection. The bibliography and Opie's 'Guillotine' entry are sources you can use if you write further. For homework, pick one primary passage from today's packet and one secondary source

from the compiled bibliography to compare." Hand out a one-line list of suggested citations: Britannica article (for overview), Opie (Guillotine), Acemoglu et al. (2011), Chisick (pamphlets).

Board: Write final synthesis sentence: 'Evidence can show influence or reflection; weigh both.' List four citations students should consult: Britannica, Opie (Guillotine), Chisick, Acemoglu et al.

- Anticipate: Which source should I use for homework? (Pick one primary passage from today and one of the four listed secondary sources.)
- Anticipate: Is Acemoglu et al. definitive? (No — it's one influential study offering empirical analysis; historians debate interpretations.)
- Anticipate: Will we use these for assessments? (Yes — these are key sources for the next assignment.)

Blackboard Notes

- Entry ticket examples & questions
- Model close read — Chisick passage
- Group task checklist
- Debate roles & prompt
- Group reports
- Synthesis & sources
- Student examples: (copy 3 from entry tickets)
- Model marks: underline = claim; circle = concrete example; note audience
- Group task: 1) List 2 pieces of evidence (quote or line #) 2) Write 1 alternative interpretation
- Roles: publisher, royalist critic, popular reader, historian
- Debate prompt: Did the pamphlet change outcomes or reflect opinion? Cite 1 evidence + 1 counter-interpretation
- Synthesis: Evidence can show influence OR reflection — weigh both
- Key citations to consult: Britannica (French Revolution), Opie (Guillotine), Chisick (pamphlets), Acemoglu et al. (2011)
- Diagram: A two-column chart labeled 'Evidence for influence' and 'Alternative interpretation' with two example rows
- Diagram: Underline and circle demo on the quoted passage (one short line underlined, one phrase circled)

Activities

Find the Evidence: How Pamphlets Shaped Debate (10 min, group_discussion)

Materials: One printed slip per group with three short excerpts from the document (see teacher instructions to prepare), Timer or stopwatch (phone is fine), One sheet of chart paper or a blank page per group, One pen or marker per group

- Before class (can be done in 10 minutes): cut the provided document into three short excerpts (each excerpt 2–3 short paragraphs). Choose excerpts that mention pamphlets/newspapers (Chisick), a specific example or named pamphlet or newspaper (from the compiled bibliography or Britannica passage), and a sentence that links press activity to consequences or public debate (for example a line that could be tied to Acemoglu et al. or Opie). Put the three excerpts together on one slip for each group.
- Arrange students in groups of 3. Give each group one slip with the three excerpts, one sheet of chart paper, and one marker. Say: 'You have 10 minutes to read the excerpts, pick one direct sentence or phrase that shows how pamphlets or newspapers influenced public debate, and

write that quote on your chart paper. Then write one short sentence that explains whether the excerpt shows the press caused change, reflected change, or both. Finally, note one scholarly source named in the excerpt.' Start the timer for 8 minutes (2 minutes for reporting).

- While groups work, circulate. For each group, quietly confirm they have identified a specific quoted phrase from the excerpt, have written which named source is referenced (for example Chisick, Britannica, Opie, or Acemoglu et al.), and are deciding between the three causal interpretations (caused, reflected, both). If a group is stalled, read aloud one sentence from their slip and ask them which of the three interpretations it best supports.
- When 8 minutes are up, call time. Ask three groups to each present in one minute: read their quoted phrase, state which interpretation they chose (caused / reflected / both) and name the scholarly source in the excerpt. Keep presentations to one minute each and use the last minute to thank groups and summarize that historians use the press as evidence but disagree on causation.

Student instructions:

- In your group, read the three short excerpts on your slip aloud. Take turns so each person hears them.
- Choose one short quoted sentence or phrase from the excerpts that most clearly shows how pamphlets or newspapers influenced public debate. Write that exact quote on your chart paper.
- Decide together: does this excerpt suggest the press caused political change, reflected changes already happening, or both? Write one short sentence on the chart paper stating your choice and one reason from the quote.
- Also write the name of one scholarly source that appears in your excerpts (for example: Chisick, Britannica, Opie, Acemoglu et al.).
- Prepare to have one person present these three things in one minute: the quote, your chosen interpretation (caused / reflected / both) and the named source.

Success looks like: Each group has a chart paper with one exact quoted phrase from the excerpts visible.; Each group verbally states one clear interpretation (caused, reflected, or both) and gives a short reason tied to the quote during their one-minute report.; Each group identifies at least one named scholarly source from the excerpt (for example Chisick, Britannica, Opie, or Acemoglu et al.) on their paper or when speaking.

Support: If you are unsure how to start, use this sentence frame to pick a quote and decide: 'This sentence shows that newspapers/pamphlets ____ (gave people information / spread opinions / pressured leaders) because ____.'

Example: 'This sentence shows that newspapers spread opinions because it says "the pamphlets argued that..."'

Pair a struggling student with a stronger reader and assign roles: reader (reads excerpts), recorder (writes the quote), reporter (presents).

Extension: Compare two excerpts from different slips (ask a neighboring group to swap one excerpt). Decide which excerpt offers stronger evidence that the press caused long-term political change. Use the Acemoglu et al. citation as a prompt: what kind of data or long-term consequence would you look for to test the claim that pamphlets helped cause broad institutional change? Write a two-sentence plan describing one piece of evidence you would seek (e.g., circulation numbers, letters to officials, changes in legislation following a pamphlet campaign).

Checkpoint Questions

- [apply] Pick the short passage your group annotated. Write one sentence that shows how the pamphlet (or newspaper) in that passage tried to change what people believed or did. Then write one sentence offering a different explanation for the same passage (it reflected opinion rather than caused it).

Expected: One-sentence influence claim naming the pamphlet/newspaper and the concrete example from the passage (for example: "The pamphlet accused local officials of hoarding grain and called for public inspections, which would push readers to demand investigations"). One-sentence alternative interpretation that cites the same passage and explains how it might report existing popular anger or copy other sources (for example: "Alternatively, the pamphlet may simply be reflecting already widespread complaints about grain prices and amplifying them, not originating them").

- [apply] From the teacher-modelled passage (Chisick/Britannica), identify the concrete example the author uses to show media influence. Say in one line how that example functions as evidence (what it links).

Expected: The student names the example used in the modelled passage (e.g., a named pamphlet, a quoted call for action, an instance of a riot or petition) and explains the link in one line (e.g., "The pamphlet's open call to join petitions links printed rhetoric to collective action because readers later formed those petitions").

- [analyze] Using Acemoglu et al. as discussed at the end of class, give one short reason a historian might argue that pamphlets mattered for long-term consequences of the Revolution, and one short reason a historian might doubt that claim.

Expected: Pro-argument: a concise statement tying printed debate to policy or institutional change (for example: "Printed debates spread new ideas that altered political coalitions, helping reforms pass, which Acemoglu et al. link to institutional change"). Contra-argument: a concise statement questioning causation or pointing to structural forces (for example: "Alternatively, structural economic pressures and elite choices, not pamphlets, may have driven reforms, so printed media were secondary").

Exit Ticket

Choose one short passage used in class and: (a) name the pamphlet/newspaper or the author cited in the passage, (b) state briefly how the passage shows the print source influenced public debate, and (c) give one plausible alternative interpretation that weakens the claim that the print source caused the change.

Success indicator: Answer includes: (a) an identified pamphlet/newspaper or author from the passage, (b) a clear link showing influence (e.g., call to action, reported response, evidence of readers acting), and (c) a plausible counter-interpretation (e.g., reflects existing opinion, copies other sources, or overstates causation).

Homework

- Select one short entry from the compiled bibliography used in class. Find (or re-read) a primary passage it cites about a pamphlet or newspaper. Copy the passage (2–4 sentences) and write a one-paragraph (6–8 sentences) explanation: two sentences summarise the passage, two sentences explain how the passage could be used as evidence that print influenced debate, and two sentences give an alternative interpretation that limits that evidence.
- Bring the paragraph and the copied passage to the next class (or upload a photo/PDF).

Estimated time: 40 min

Mentor Moment — A printer's slip that changed a crowd

In 1790s France a poorly phrased handbill blamed market women for shortages; a printer rushed copies and crowds reacted before authorities could respond.

Takeaway: Small wording in a pamphlet can spark immediate action, so when you judge influence look closely at exactly what was printed and how people could read it.

Learning Gaps & Misconceptions

[high] All revolutionaries supported the Reign of Terror and worked together to carry out the mass executions — it was a single, unified revolutionary policy everyone agreed on.

- Diagnostic: Why was Maximilien Robespierre arrested and executed in July 1794?

Reveals: If a student answers that he was executed because all revolutionaries agreed he needed to be removed as the enforcer of a unified policy of terror, it shows they see the Terror as monolithic rather than the result of factional conflict and loss of political support.

- Diagnostic: If you read an 1793 newspaper from a Parisian radical club praising revolutionary violence and a 1793 letter from a moderate deputy condemning the same violence, what would you conclude about revolutionary opinion?

Reveals: If a student insists the two sources just show the whole Revolution supported violence (and the moderate deputy is an outlier or irrelevant), they are not recognising multiple influential factions and disagreements within revolutionary politics.

- Remediation: Source-comparison mini-DBQ (30 minutes): give students four short primary-source extracts (a Hébertist paper article calling for severe measures, Danton's criticisms of extreme procedures, Robespierre's speech defending virtue and terror, and a Thermidorian deputy's speech from July 1794). Ask students in pairs to annotate each for stance on repression, intended audience, and whether the writer supports or opposes mass executions.

Why: Comparing contemporaneous primary sources makes the disagreement visible in students' own work. They must identify conflicting positions and audiences, which counters the idea of a single revolutionary voice by showing evidence of organised and influential internal critics and supporters.

- Remediation: Structured role-play debate (20 minutes): assign small groups to represent Hébertists, Dantonists, Robespierrists, and Thermidorians. Each group prepares two short statements (one rhetorical justification, one policy demand) using quoted phrases from real speeches. Hold a timed debate focused on who should control repression and why.

Why: Adopting a faction's voice forces students to articulate concrete, conflicting goals and reveals that 'the Revolution' was a coalition of groups with competing agendas. Acting out shifts in rhetoric shows how alliances and enmities, not unanimous consent, shaped who was arrested or executed.

- Remediation: Create a cause-and-effect timeline (15 minutes): students place key events (committees formed, major arrests, executions of Hébert, Danton, Robespierre, votes in Convention) on a timeline and annotate each entry with which faction benefited or lost influence.

Why: A timeline linking events to factional gains/losses makes the causal pattern visible: repression often follows factional contests and changing power balances. This addresses the root error (seeing only scale and centralisation) by focusing attention on sequence and political context rather than treating executions as evidence of unanimous revolutionary policy.

[high] The French Revolution happened mainly because of one big cause — either Enlightenment ideas inspiring people or heavy taxes/starvation — so if you point to that one cause you've explained the Revolution.

- Diagnostic: Look at these three short sources: a government budget report showing growing

debt, a peasant letter describing a bad harvest and rising bread prices, and a pamphlet quoting Enlightenment criticisms of privilege. Which single source best explains why the Revolution began in 1789? Explain your choice in one sentence.

Reveals: If a student picks one source as 'the' explanation, they treat causes as mutually exclusive and are likely to overvalue one type of evidence (ideological vs economic vs material).

- Diagnostic: Which was more important in causing the French Revolution: a) long-term social and economic trends (population growth, rising prices, tax structure) that built pressure over decades, or b) short-term shocks (bad harvests, a fiscal crisis in 1788, and the calling of the Estates-General)? Choose one and justify in one sentence.

Reveals: If a student insists one single category explains the Revolution, they cannot integrate interacting long-term and short-term factors and will later struggle with analysing causation and contingency.

- Remediation: Conduct a 20–25 minute timed 'Cause Map' activity: give small groups a mixed stack of primary-source extracts and short data summaries (population graphs, bread price chart, tax revenue table, Enlightenment pamphlet excerpt, letter from a noble, account of the Estates-General) and ask them to place the items on a two-axis chart (long-term to short-term on one axis; structural to immediate trigger on the other), then write a single paragraph explaining how at least three items interacted to produce 1789.

Why: Arranging sources on intersecting axes forces students to treat causes as non-exclusive and to link long-term structural trends with short-term triggers. Using primary evidence and quantitative summaries grounds claims in the historical record instead of abstract labels, and the requirement to explain interactions practices causal reasoning rather than naming a single cause.

- Remediation: Run a 10–15 minute instructor-led comparative timeline: present a concise timeline that overlays demographic growth, grain prices, state debt/government deficits, and publication dates of influential pamphlets, with class discussion prompts asking which developments preceded others and how one might have enabled the next (e.g., how rising bread prices affected urban unrest which made pamphlets more influential). Include brief citations (e.g., fiscal registers, price series, publishing records) for each data line.

Why: Overlaying different kinds of evidence on the same timeline makes sequencing and causal proximity visible; students see that intellectual, economic, and political factors coexisted and often amplified one another. Citing documentary sources models how historians weigh competing interpretations.

- Remediation: Assign a 10–15 minute 'competing interpretations' exit task: give two short historian summaries (one emphasising structural socioeconomic causes, one emphasising political crisis and contingency) and ask students to write two sentences: first, what evidence each historian uses; second, how both interpretations could be true together (specify at least one mechanism linking them).

Why: Presenting competing but evidence-based interpretations trains students to evaluate perspective and causation rather than accept a single neat explanation. Requiring a mechanism to connect interpretations focuses attention on causation (how factors interact), addressing the root tendency to prefer single-cause stories.

[high] The Estates General simply renamed itself the National Assembly and everyone (the king and all three estates) agreed to that change, so the Estates General became the new government at once.

- Diagnostic: On 17 June 1789 the Third Estate declared itself the National Assembly. Which of these best describes what happened immediately after: (A) The king recognised the National Assembly and the Estates General stopped meeting; (B) The Third Estate declared the National

Assembly but the king and many clergy and nobles still treated the Estates General as the official body and resisted the change?

Reveals: Whether the student appreciates that the Third Estate's declaration was a contested political act, not an immediate legal transformation accepted by all parties.

- **Diagnostic:** Which group voted to establish the National Assembly in June 1789: (A) A unanimous vote of delegates from all three estates together, or (B) a unilateral decision by the Third Estate and some sympathetic clergy which other estates and the king did not immediately accept?

Reveals: Whether the student understands that the National Assembly originated from the Third Estate asserting authority, rather than a joint decision by all estates or royal approval.

- **Remediation:** Source-pair activity (20 minutes): give students two short primary extracts—one paragraph from the Third Estate's proclamation/tennis-court oath and one paragraph of a royal or noble statement from June 1789—and ask pairs to summarise what each author thinks has happened and whether each accepts the new National Assembly.

Why: Comparing contemporaneous voices makes the contested nature of the declaration visible: students must confront that the Third Estate claimed authority while other actors did not immediately accept it, correcting the assumption of instant, unanimous acceptance.

- **Remediation:** Timeline card-sort (15 minutes): students order ten dated cards (e.g., calling of Estates General, vote about voting by head vs order, 17 June Third Estate declaration, King's response on 23 June, Tennis Court Oath, sessions where clergy/nobles join) and annotate where authority was disputed.

Why: Sequencing events forces attention to chronology and shows the gradual shift in authority; by placing contested responses next to the Third Estate's claim, students see political change as a process, not a single name-change.

- **Remediation:** Role-play short debate (15 minutes): assign small groups roles (Third Estate deputies, clergy sympathetic, conservative clergy/nobles, royal representative). Give each group a short position card and run a 6–8 minute structured exchange, then debrief about who recognised whom and why change was incremental.

Why: Acting the positions helps students experience conflict of recognition: they must negotiate legitimacy rather than assume it, which confronts their tendency to imagine a single, uncontested institutional change.

[medium] The Bastille held a large number of political prisoners when the crowd stormed it on 14 July 1789, and many political detainees were freed that day.

- **Diagnostic:** When the crowd stormed the Bastille in Paris on 14 July 1789, did the crowd free many political prisoners (for example dozens or hundreds)? Explain your answer.

Reveals: If a student answers 'yes' or cites large numbers, they are treating the Bastille's symbolic status as evidence that it actually contained many political detainees at that time.

- **Diagnostic:** How many prisoners were held in the Bastille on the morning of 14 July 1789? Choose a number and justify it with what you would expect to find in contemporary records.

Reveals: If the student gives a large number, they cannot distinguish between later revolutionary symbolism and contemporary documentary evidence (prison registers, eyewitness reports).

- **Remediation:** Provide students with short primary-source excerpts: the Bastille's prisoner register or a transcription (showing the names and the total), contemporary eyewitness accounts from 14–15 July 1789, and a brief extract from a later revolutionary commemorative text. In pairs, ask students to list what each source actually says about how many prisoners were inside.

Why: Grounds the fact in contemporary documentary evidence rather than memory or symbolism. Confronting the prison register and eyewitness accounts lets students see the concrete number (seven) and compare it with later commemorative texts that amplify meaning; this addresses the root error of conflating symbolic narratives with primary evidence.

- Remediation: Run a short class activity that contrasts 'symbolic significance' and 'material fact': display images/quotes that present the Bastille as a symbol (e.g., revolutionary prints, speeches, monuments) alongside the primary-source evidence about prisoner numbers. Ask students to create a two-column chart: 'What people said/remembered later' vs 'What contemporaneous records show' and then discuss why a small factual detail could become a large symbol.

Why: Explicitly separates representation from reality and cultivates historical thinking about memory, myth-making, and how events are reinterpreted. This corrects the tendency to generalise from later, emotionally charged narratives back onto the historical facts of July 1789.

- Remediation: Facilitate a short structured discussion or written prompt: 'If the Bastille only held a few prisoners, why did revolutionaries attack and demolish it? Use evidence from the primary sources and the commemorative texts to support your answer.' Have students cite specific lines from the extracts.

Why: Encourages causal and contextual reasoning—students must explain why a small number of inmates did not prevent the site from being a major target. This replaces the simple inference 'big symbol = lots of prisoners' with a richer account (political authority, royal licences, reputation, and symbolic power) grounded in sources, aligning with the pedagogical emphasis on causation and interpretation.

[medium] The National Assembly just seized Church land to get money and the Church (and most ordinary Catholics) uniformly resisted because priests were defending their wealth and power — so the Civil Constitution simply turned all clergy into state enemies of the Revolution.

- Diagnostic: The Civil Constitution required priests to swear an oath to the state. If you looked at records from one department and found that 60% of parish priests took the oath and 40% refused, what does that tell you about how clergy reacted nationwide?

Reveals: Whether the student recognises that reactions were mixed and locally variable rather than uniformly hostile.

- Diagnostic: Peasants in many areas lost their traditional obligations (tithes) when Church property was nationalised. Did that make peasants everywhere supporters of the Assembly? Explain briefly.

Reveals: Whether the student understands that economic gain did not automatically produce political support and that religious loyalty, local ties and fear of disruption influenced responses.

- Remediation: Present two short primary-source case studies (8–10 minutes each): one parish where the priest swore the oath and one where the priest refused. Students read a petition/letter or short excerpt from each and list the reasons given by priests and parishioners for their choices.

Why: Direct voices from the period show varied motives (financial need, patriotic belief, pastoral duty, fear of losing parish) and reveal local pressures; this challenges the blanket idea of uniform resistance by grounding judgment in contemporaneous evidence.

- Remediation: Show a simple map/chart (5–10 minutes) of departments with percentages of constitutional vs refractory clergy alongside indicators such as proximity to cities, strength of

local seigneurial structures, and landholding patterns; ask students to suggest factors that correlate with different patterns.

Why: Visualising regional variation links the policy to social and economic context, countering the 'one-size-fits-all' story and prompting causal reasoning about why responses differed.

- Remediation: Run a short role-play or structured debate (15 minutes) where students take roles: an urban revolutionary official, a parish priest with a small stipend, a wealthy bishop, and a peasant household. Each must explain whether they support the Civil Constitution and why, using at least one factual point from the primary sources or the map.

Why: Adopting perspectives forces students to weigh competing interests (state finance, local pastoral care, religious conviction, material benefit) and demonstrates that actions labelled as 'support' or 'resistance' often had mixed, pragmatic motives rather than a single ideological cause.

[medium] The 'Revolutionary Wars' were just a few short battles around France against nearby kings — basically limited campaigns — not a mass mobilisation that reshaped Europe or created new client states.

- Diagnostic: Compare France in 1790 and 1796: which of the following best describes what changed because of the Revolutionary Wars — (A) only the government changed but armies stayed small and professional; (B) France mobilised large citizen armies, fought across multiple theatres, and by the mid-1790s had annexed some neighbouring territories and set up allied republics; (C) France only fought defensive battles on its borders and made no permanent territorial gains.

Reveals: If a student chooses A or C, they treat the wars as limited or defensive and miss mass mobilisation and territorial/political consequences.

- Diagnostic: Which document is strongest evidence that the Revolutionary Wars depended on mass mobilisation rather than just professional soldiers: (A) a general's campaign diary describing a single battle, (B) the 1793 levée en masse decree calling on citizens to serve, (C) a treaty between two monarchs in 1789?

Reveals: Choosing A or C shows the student prioritises individual leaders or diplomacy over social mobilisation and cannot connect primary-source policies (conscription) to military scale.

- Remediation: Begin the lesson with two short primary-source excerpts: the 1793 levée en masse decree and a dispatch describing a 1796 campaign in Italy plus a contemporary map (1792 vs 1796) showing territorial changes and new sister republics. Ask students in pairs to list what each source reveals about who fought, where, and what political consequences followed.

Why: Confronts the source of the error (overreliance on single-battle narratives) by having students use documentary evidence that links policy (conscription) to scale (mass armies) and to territorial/political outcomes; comparing maps makes structural change visible rather than abstract.

- Remediation: Run a quick quantitative comparison activity: give small groups data points (estimated troop numbers 1791 vs 1794, number of theatres, and instances of annexation/creation of sister states). Ask each group to draw a short causal chain from 'levée en masse' to one concrete result (for example, from conscription larger army offensive operations in the Low Countries annexation/creation of Batavian Republic).

Why: Makes the causal mechanism explicit so students stop treating events as isolated; connecting policy to numbers and then to political outcomes corrects the tendency to see wars as merely episodic fights led by generals.

- Remediation: Facilitate a brief competing-interpretations discussion: present two historians'

short positions (one emphasising military leaders and battles, one arguing social mobilisation and export of revolution were decisive). Ask students to weigh the evidence from the primary sources and maps and vote which explanation better fits the evidence, justifying their choice with specific references.

Why: Models historical thinking required by the course — students must compare interpretations and ground judgments in evidence, which addresses the misconception by showing why the mobilisation/export-of-revolution interpretation better explains annexations and multi-theatre campaigning.